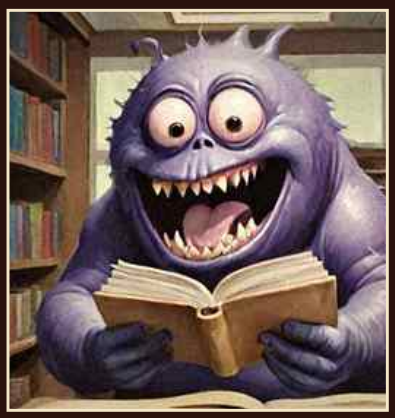
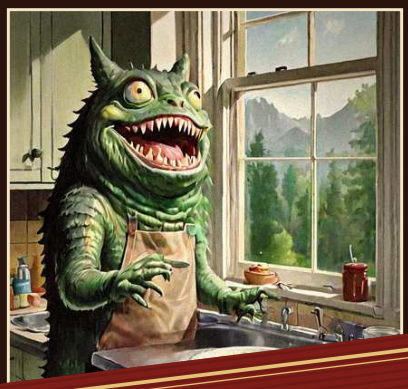
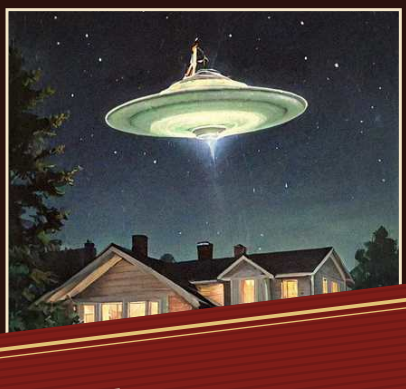
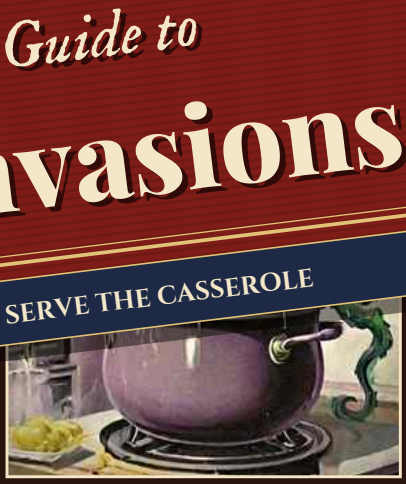



# The Housewife's Guide to Alien Invasions

KEEP CALM AND SERVE THE CASSEROLE






HOMEMAKING
60
SKILLS

# THE HOUSEWIFE'S GUIDE TO ALIEN INVASIONS



EX LIBRIS

*This book belongs to*

_____
__

*and their household,* _____

*The Housewife's Guide to*

# ALIEN INVASIONS

*60 Essential Skills for the Modern Homemaker When the Saucers Land*

AN ILLUSTRATED HANDBOOK FOR KEEPING HOUSE WHILE THE GALAXY COMES TO CALL

FUN BOOKS · HOME EDITION · 2026

**The Housewife's Guide to Alien Invasions**: 60 Essential Skills for the Modern Homemaker When the Saucers Land. Fun Books Home Edition, 2026.

Written and illustrated as an original work. The text and pictures in this book were created from scratch for this edition and are not copied from any other publication.

**Please read before using this book.** This is a work of good-natured humor. Every housewife, husband, visitor, saucer and Galactic Overlord in it is made up, and any resemblance to your own neighbors (from this planet or any other) is a coincidence. Please do not try the tractor-beam, shrink-ray or freeze-ray advice at home. Do try the casserole.

**Printing tips.** This book is laid out on US Letter (8.5 x 11 in) pages. Print double-sided, “flip on long edge”, at 100% scale. For a book that lies flat on the kitchen table, ask a copy shop for spiral or comb binding with a clear front and a heavy back cover.

Made with care for every homemaker who has ever set a table for more guests than she expected.

*For every housewife who kept her head*
*when everyone around her lost theirs.*

# CONTENTS


Introduction: How to Use This Book . . . . . 11

1. The Day the Saucers Landed . . . . . 13

- Spotting a Flying Saucer . . . . . 14
- Telling an Alien From the Milkman . . . . . 15
- Finding a Crop Circle in the Petunias . . . . . 16
- Understanding the Radio Bulletin . . . . . 17
- Is That Really Your Husband? . . . . . 18
- Keeping the Household Calm . . . . . 19

2. Saucer-Proofing the Home . . . . . 20

- Hanging Tinfoil Curtains . . . . . 21
- Stocking the Invasion Pantry . . . . . 22
- Making the Basement Shelter Cozy . . . . . 23
- Planting an Alien-Repelling Marigold Border . . . . . 24
- Ray-Proofing the Good China . . . . . 25
- Anchoring the Station Wagon Against Tractor Beams . . . . . 26
- Keeping the Lawn Saucer-Free . . . . . 27
- Making Your House Look Boring From Above . . . . . 28

3. Entertaining Visitors From Beyond . . . . . 29

- Answering the Door to an Alien . . . . . 30
- Setting the Table for a Guest With Seven Arms . . . . . 31
- Making Small Talk With a Martian . . . . . 32
- Hosting a Bridge Party With Visitors . . . . . 33
- Seating a Guest Who Won't Fit on the Sofa . . . . . 34
- Serving Coffee to Something With No Mouth . . . . . 35
- Saying Goodbye Without Being Abducted . . . . . 36

4. Feeding the Invaders . . . . . 37

- Tuna Casserole for Forty Mouths . . . . . 38
- The Peacekeeping Green Gelatin Mold . . . . . 39
- Meatloaf Diplomacy . . . . . 40
- Packing a Lunch for a Long Space Voyage . . . . . 41

Baking a Welcome-to-Earth Cake . . . 42
Feeding a Visitor Who Eats Metal . . . 43

5. Housekeeping in a Time of Invasion . . . 44
Getting Alien Slime Out of the Carpet . . . 45
Laundering a Space Suit . . . 46
Vacuuming Up a Very Small Alien (and Letting It Out) . . . 47
Polishing a Flying Saucer . . . 48
Defrosting the Kitchen After a Freeze Ray . . . 49
Putting a Many-Armed Visitor to Work . . . 50
Getting Ray-Gun Scorch Marks Off the Wallpaper . . . 51

6. Children, Pets and Little Green Men . . . 52
When Junior Brings One Home . . . 53
Babysitting a Baby From Beyond . . . 54
Walking a Space Pet . . . 55
Calming a Dog Who Barks at Saucers . . . 56
Explaining Aliens at Bedtime . . . 57
Sewing a Halloween Costume Nobody Will Question . . . 58

7. Out and About . . . 59
Grocery Shopping During an Invasion . . . 60
Getting Your Hair Set Next to a Martian . . . 61
Taking a Visitor to the Public Library . . . 62
Bringing a Visitor to the PTA Meeting . . . 63
A Church Picnic With Unexpected Guests . . . 64
League Night With a Tentacled Bowler . . . 65
Buying a Hat for a Head Shaped Like That . . . 66

8. Unusual Situations . . . 67
Being Beamed Up With Your Hair Still Set . . . 68
Escaping a Tractor Beam With the Vacuum Cleaner . . . 69
Living Through a Shrink Ray . . . 70
When a Forty-Foot Visitor Sits on the House . . . 71
Talking Down the Galactic Overlord . . . 72
Fixing a Saucer That Crashed in the Garden . . . 73
Visiting the Mothership . . . 74

9. Peace Between the Planets . . . . . 75
Throwing a Welcome-to-the-Neighborhood Potluck . . . . . 76
Teaching an Alien to Dance at the Sock Hop . . . . . 77
Swapping Recipes Across the Galaxy . . . . . 78
Hosting a Plastic Container Party for the Visitors . . . . . 79
Writing to a Pen Pal on Mars . . . . . 80
Waving Goodbye at the Launch Pad . . . . . 81

Appendix . . . . . 82
A. Field Guide to Visitors . . . . . 82
B. Feeding Chart . . . . . 82
C. Checklists . . . . . 83
D. Household Remedies for Space Stains . . . . . 84
E. Handy Invasion Conversions . . . . . 84
F. Household Invasion Card . . . . . 85
G. Glossary . . . . . 86
H. Where to Learn More . . . . . 86

Index . . . . . 87

My Skills Log . . . . . 91

Notes . . . . . 93

# INTRODUCTION

*How to use this book*

There was a time, not so long ago, when the most alarming thing to land on an American lawn was the morning paper. Those days are over. Whether it started with a strange hum over the backyard, a crop circle in the petunias or a milkman with three eyes, the visitors are here, and they seem to be staying for supper.

Most households are not ready. Nobody teaches invasion manners in home economics. Cookbooks say nothing about tentacles. The radio only makes it worse. This book is here to help. It gathers everything a sensible homemaker needs to know to stay calm, keep house, feed the guests and still have dinner on the table by six.

**What you'll find inside.** Sixty skills in nine chapters, each on a single page laid out the same way: a picture for every step, a short explanation of why it matters, a materials panel with what you'll need, and a notes panel with tips and the most important warnings. Colored tabs on the edge of every page tell you which chapter you're in, so you can find the right page quickly, even while a saucer hums over the house.

**How to use it.** Don't wait for an emergency. Read the first chapter tonight, before the first saucer lands. Hang the tinfoil curtains. Freeze a tuna casserole. Practice opening the front door with a calm smile. Each skill you practice now is one less scream later.

**Start with the basics.** If the visitors have already arrived, begin with Chapter 1 (the signs), the invasion pantry in Chapter 2, answering the door in Chapter 3 and the green gelatin mold in Chapter 4. Those four alone will put your household well ahead of the Hendersons, who have been hiding in the coat closet since Tuesday.

**The appendix** at the back gathers the charts and checklists you'll reach for most: a field guide to visitors, a feeding chart, a list of household remedies for space stains, handy invasion conversions, emergency checklists, a household invasion card, a glossary, and a log for the skills your household has mastered.

**A word on kindness.** Most of the visitors are not here to conquer anybody. They are curious, a little lost and very, very hungry, much like the rest of us. This book is about keeping a happy home while the galaxy comes to call. Watch for the boxes marked **Important**, and remember that the best defense in any invasion is a calm voice and a warm casserole.

## CHAPTERS AT A GLANCE

| CHAPTER | WHAT IT COVERS | SKILLS |
|---|---|---|
| 1. The Day the Saucers Landed | How to recognize an invasion before the casserole gets cold | 6 |
| 2. Saucer-Proofing the Home | Making your house cozy, safe and slightly shiny | 8 |
| 3. Entertaining Visitors From Beyond | Gracious hospitality for guests with more than two arms | 7 |
| 4. Feeding the Invaders | Recipes and kitchen wisdom for appetites from outer space | 6 |
| 5. Housekeeping in a Time of Invasion | Getting slime out of the shag and other modern problems | 7 |
| 6. Children, Pets and Little Green Men | What to do when the kids bring one home | 6 |
| 7. Out and About | Shopping, errands and the beauty parlor during an invasion | 7 |
| 8. Unusual Situations | Tractor beams, shrink rays and other household emergencies | 7 |
| 9. Peace Between the Planets | Making friends across the galaxy, one casserole at a time | 6 |

CHAPTER ONE

1

# THE DAY THE SAUCERS LANDED

*How to recognize an invasion before the casserole gets cold*







It usually begins on a Tuesday, right between the breakfast dishes and the ironing. The milkman is late, the radio is crackling, and something large and shiny has parked itself on the Hendersons' lawn. Do not panic. A housewife who has survived a church bake sale can survive anything from outer space. This chapter helps you spot the signs early, keep your head and your hairdo, and get supper on the table regardless.

IN THIS CHAPTER


01 Spotting a Flying Saucer
02 Telling an Alien From the Milkman
03 Finding a Crop Circle in the Petunias
04 Understanding the Radio Bulletin
05 Is That Really Your Husband?
06 Keeping the Household Calm

HOW TO

# SPOTTING A FLYING SAUCER

SKILL 01 · THE DAY THE SAUCERS LANDED · 5 MINUTES · EASY

## MATERIALS

- Your reading glasses



- A pair of opera glasses



- A cup of strong coffee



- A pie tin (for comparison)



- A notepad and pencil



*Before you telephone your sister, be sure. Many a housewife has woken the whole street over a weather balloon, a pie tin on the clothesline or a very shiny hubcap. A genuine saucer passes five simple tests.*

1



### *Look Up From the Dishes*

Most sightings happen at the kitchen window. Dry your hands before pointing.

2



### *Compare With a Pie Tin*

Hold a pie tin at arm's length. If the thing in the sky is bigger and humming, it is a saucer.

3

### *Check for Blinking Lights*

Saucers blink in colors no American appliance has ever used. Write them down.



4



### *Listen for the Hum*

A saucer hums like a refrigerator that is thinking very hard.

5



### *Watch for Little Visitors*

If a hatch opens and something with eyes on stalks waves at you, the matter is settled.

6



### *Take Notes for the Bridge Club*

Time, color, size and number of eyes. The girls will want details.

## NOTES

A saucer that lands in the begonias has no manners, but it may still be friendly.

**IMPORTANT**

Never wave a dish towel at a saucer. In some galaxies that is a declaration of war.

HOW TO

# TELLING AN ALIEN FROM THE MILKMAN

SKILL 02 · THE DAY THE SAUCERS LANDED · 10 MINUTES · EASY

*Visitors from beyond often try to blend in, and the milk delivery is a favorite disguise. Fortunately there are ways to tell the difference without being rude to either.*

1



### *Count the Eyes*

The milkman has two. If you count past three, do not sign for anything.

2



### *Check the Bottles*

Real milk is white. Milk that glows green came from much farther than the dairy.

3



### *Look at the Truck*

A milk truck has wheels. A milk truck that floats did not come from the dairy.

4



### *Mind the Footprints*

Muddy boot prints are the milkman. Slimy suction-cup prints are not.

5



### *Ask About the Weather*

The milkman will say 'Looks like rain.' A visitor will say 'Which sun?'

## MATERIALS


A fresh bottle of milk


A magnifying glass


Your best company manners


A doormat


A nickel for the tip

## NOTES

Order an extra quart. Visitors are always thirsty after a long trip.

**IMPORTANT**

Do not shut the door on a tentacle. It upsets them, and it is very hard to get out of the paint.



6 ### *Tip Them Both*

Whoever it is, a nickel and a smile keep the deliveries coming.

HOW TO

# FINDING A CROP CIRCLE IN THE PETUNIAS

SKILL 03 · THE DAY THE SAUCERS LANDED · 30 MINUTES · EASY

*Visitors like to leave a calling card, and a perfect circle pressed into the flower bed is their way of saying 'We were here, and we liked your garden.'*

## MATERIALS

- Garden gloves



- A trowel



- A ball of string



- A watering can



- Petunia seedlings (for repairs)



1



### *Look Out the Back Window*

If the flower bed now makes a pattern you could see from an airplane, you have had company.

2



### *Walk the Rings*

Step carefully along the edge and count the rings. More rings means a bigger saucer.

3

### *Measure With String*

Pin one end in the middle and walk around. This is also how you plan a very round rose bed.



4



### *Check for Scorch Marks*

A light singeing means a gentle landing. A big black ring means a student driver.

5



### *Look for the Gift*

Visitors often leave something behind: a glowing pebble, a strange seed, a single sock.

6



### *Replant With Pride*

Fill in the rings with fresh petunias. The neighbors will think you planned it.

## NOTES

Photograph the circle before you replant. The garden club will never believe you otherwise.

**IMPORTANT**

If the circle is still warm, wait for it to cool. So should you.

HOW TO

# UNDERSTANDING THE RADIO BULLETIN

SKILL 04 · THE DAY THE SAUCERS LANDED · 15 MINUTES · EASY

*When the regular program is interrupted 'for an important announcement', the housewife who listens calmly will know exactly what to do, and the one who screams will miss the recipe at the end.*

1



### *Turn It Up*

Switch off the mixer and raise the volume. Bulletins are always read very fast.

2



### *Write Down the Key Words*

Saucer. Landing. Elm Street. Remain calm. Underline the street.

3



### *Ignore the Shouting*

The announcer may be excited. That is his job, not yours.

**MATERIALS**


A wooden table radio


A cup of tea


A pencil and pad


A comfortable chair


A spare radio tube

4



### *Listen for Instructions*

If they say 'stay indoors', put the kettle on. If they say 'welcome them', put on lipstick.

5



### *Check Out the Window*

See whether the bulletin matches the view. It usually does.

## NOTES

Keep a spare radio tube in the kitchen drawer. Invasions always happen the day one burns out.

**IMPORTANT**

Never telephone the radio station to ask if it's real. Forty other housewives already have.



6 ### *Carry On With Supper*

Bulletins come and go. Pot roast waits for no one.

HOW TO

# IS THAT REALLY YOUR HUSBAND?

SKILL 05 · THE DAY THE SAUCERS LANDED · 10 MINUTES · MEDIUM

*Some visitors are shy and prefer to borrow a familiar shape. If your husband comes home on time, compliments the meatloaf and offers to do the dishes, it is wise to check.*

## MATERIALS

- His favorite slippers



- The evening newspaper



- A plate of meatloaf



- A family photograph



- The office telephone number



1



*Watch Him Come In*

Does he hang his hat on the hook? Real husbands never do.

2



*Offer the Slippers*

A real husband sighs with joy. A visitor tries to eat them.

3

*Check Behind the Newspaper*

If three eyes on stalks are peeking over the sports page, you have your answer.



4



*Serve the Meatloaf*

Your husband will ask for ketchup. A visitor will ask what meat is.

5



*Compare With the Photograph*

Hold up the wedding picture. Antennae are a giveaway.

6



*Call the Office*

If your real husband is still at the office, simply set another place at the table.

## NOTES

A visitor who does the dishes may be worth keeping until Thursday.

**IMPORTANT**

Do not test him by asking him to take out the trash. Neither version will.

HOW TO

# KEEPING THE HOUSEHOLD CALM

SKILL 06 · THE DAY THE SAUCERS LANDED · 30 MINUTES · EASY

*The children shriek, the dog barks and your husband wants to drive straight to the saucer. The housewife's job is to restore order, and a plate of cookies does more than any army.*

1



*Blow the Whistle*

One short blast. Everyone stops, including the visitor.

2



*Count the Children*

Make sure you have the same number you started with. Check under the beds.

3



*Put On a Record*

Soft music soothes children, dogs and creatures from Neptune alike.

**MATERIALS**


A plate of warm cookies


A whistle


A pitcher of lemonade


The family's favorite record


A cool washcloth

4



*Pass the Cookies*

Nobody screams with a mouth full of oatmeal raisin.

5



*Use Your Telephone Voice*

Low, sweet and firm. It works on the PTA and it works on Martians.

## NOTES

Hide your husband's car keys for the first hour. He means well, but he will want to go and look.

**IMPORTANT**

Never let the children name the visitor until you know whether it is staying.



6 *Rest With a Washcloth*

Once peace returns, lie on the sofa with a cool cloth for exactly ten minutes.

CHAPTER TWO

2

# SAUCER-PROOFING THE HOME

*Making your house cozy, safe and slightly shiny*







A well-kept home is the best defense against anything, from muddy boots to death rays. With a few rolls of aluminum foil, a well-stocked pantry and the right curtains, any housewife can turn her split-level into a fortress that still looks lovely for company. Best of all, most of what you need is already in the kitchen drawer.

IN THIS CHAPTER


07 Hanging Tinfoil Curtains
08 Stocking the Invasion Pantry
09 Making the Basement Shelter Cozy
10 Planting an Alien-Repelling Marigold Border
11 Ray-Proofing the Good China
12 Anchoring the Station Wagon Against Tractor Beams
13 Keeping the Lawn Saucer-Free
14 Making Your House Look Boring From Above

HOW TO

# HANGING TINFOIL CURTAINS

SKILL 07 · SAUCER-PROOFING THE HOME · 1 HOUR · EASY

*Scientists agree that aluminum foil confuses alien instruments. Housewives agree that it brightens a room. Everyone wins.*

1



### *Measure the Windows*

Foil curtains should reach the sill. Shorter ones let the rays in.

2



### *Unroll the Foil*

Pull out long, smooth sheets. Wrinkles are fine; they scatter signals.

3

### *Pin It to the Rod*

Use clothespins, spaced like a nice pleat.



4



### *Add a Ruffle*

A foil ruffle along the top makes it look intentional.

5



### *Test the Shine*

Close the curtains. If the visitor outside squints and turns away, it works.

6



### *Admire Your Work*

Step back and enjoy. They also keep the sofa from fading.

## NOTES

Save the cardboard tubes. The children can make telescopes to watch for more saucers.

**IMPORTANT**

Never use your good foil. Save that for the Christmas ham.

## MATERIALS

- Six rolls of aluminum foil



- A curtain rod



- Clothespins



- A step stool



- Scissors



HOW TO

# STOCKING THE INVASION PANTRY

SKILL 08 · SAUCER-PROOFING THE HOME · 2 HOURS · EASY

*When the saucers land, the supermarket fills with people buying tinned peaches. The wise housewife is already at home with a full shelf and a can opener.*

## MATERIALS


Canned goods (lots)


A hand can opener


Jars of jam


Shelf paper


A grease pencil

### 1 *Clear a Shelf*



Remove the fondue set nobody uses. This shelf now belongs to the invasion.

### 2 *Line It With Paper*



Pretty shelf paper keeps cans from rusting and spirits from sinking.

### 3 *Stack the Cans*



Soup at the front, peaches at the back, labels facing out.

### 4 *Add the Treats*



An invasion without cookies is just a bad week.

### 5 *Label Everything*



Write the date on top. Some visitors eat labels.



### 6 *Guard the Door*

If something with tentacles is sniffing around the pantry, offer it the creamed corn.

## NOTES

Visitors adore canned fruit cocktail. Keep two extra cans for diplomacy.

**IMPORTANT**

Never keep the can opener in the pantry. Keep it in your apron pocket.

HOW TO

# MAKING THE BASEMENT SHELTER COZY

SKILL 09 · SAUCER-PROOFING THE HOME · HALF A DAY · MEDIUM

*Every good home has a basement, and every basement can become a snug little hideaway with a few cushions, a card table and a lamp. You may be down there a while, so make it pretty.*

1



*Sweep the Stairs*

Visitors never use the stairs, but you will.

2



*Lay the Rug*

A braided rug turns a cold floor into a parlor.

3

*Set Up the Card Table*

For meals, games and letters to your congressman about the saucers.



4



*Bring Down the Cushions*

One for each of the family, plus a spare in case of guests from Venus.

5



*Light the Lamp*

A warm lamp keeps up morale. Glowing tubes attract the wrong crowd.

6



*Test It With a Game Night*

Play a round of checkers. If you lose to the visitor, it got in.

## NOTES

A basement with doilies is a basement you will want to come back to after the invasion.

**IMPORTANT**

Do not invite the visitor into the shelter. That rather defeats the purpose.

## MATERIALS

- A braided rug



- Floor cushions



- A card table



- A table lamp



- Board games



HOW TO

# PLANTING AN ALIEN-REPELLING MARIGOLD BORDER

SKILL 10 · SAUCER-PROOFING THE HOME · 2 HOURS · EASY

*Old gardeners say marigolds keep away rabbits, aphids and things from Saturn. Whether or not it's true, your front walk will look cheerful.*

## MATERIALS


Marigold seedlings


A trowel


Garden gloves


A watering can


A kneeling pad

**1**



### *Choose the Border*

Plant along the front walk, where visitors are most likely to land.

**2**



### *Dig the Holes*

Six inches apart and a hand deep.

**3**



### *Plant the Marigolds*

Orange ones alarm visitors the most. Yellow ones are a backup.

**4**



### *Water Generously*

A well-watered marigold is a brave marigold.

**5**



### *Watch the Results*

Visitors who meet a marigold usually sneeze and leave.



**6** ### *Pick a Bouquet*

Bring some indoors. Any visitor who gets past the border deserves flowers.

## NOTES

Plant a few extra by the clothesline. Something from Pluto once took a whole week of laundry.

**IMPORTANT**

If the visitor eats the marigolds, it is not working. Try zinnias.

HOW TO

# RAY-PROOFING THE GOOD CHINA

SKILL 11 · SAUCER-PROOFING THE HOME · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

*Your grandmother's china survived two wars and forty Thanksgivings. It would be a shame to lose it to a stray beam. A little padding and a sturdy cabinet keep it safe.*

1



### *Take Stock*

Count every cup and saucer and write the number down.

2



### *Wrap Each Piece*

Tissue first, then a towel, like tucking in a baby.

3

### *Pack the Box*

Heaviest at the bottom, teacups on top.



4



### *Lock the Cabinet*

Keep the key on a ribbon around your neck.

5



### *Keep a Pot Holder Handy*

If a beam comes through the window, a quilted pot holder deflects it nicely.

6



### *Bring It Out for Company*

When the danger passes, use it. China is for living.

## NOTES

Melmac plates bounce. Use them for visitors until you know them better.

**IMPORTANT**

Never serve a visitor tea in the gravy boat. It confuses everyone.

## MATERIALS

- Tissue paper



- Cotton dish towels



- A sturdy box



- A quilted pot holder



- The china cabinet key



HOW TO

# ANCHORING THE STATION WAGON AGAINST TRACTOR BEAMS

SKILL 12 · SAUCER-PROOFING THE HOME · 30 MINUTES · MEDIUM

*A tractor beam can lift a car right off the driveway, and then how will you get to the A&P? A clothesline and a sturdy tree solve the problem.*

## MATERIALS


A long clothesline


A sturdy tree


Two bricks


Work gloves


The car keys

**1**



### *Park Near a Tree*

The oak by the driveway is best. Elms are too nervous.

**2**



### *Tie the Bumper*

Use a double knot. Then another.

**3**



### *Loop the Tree*

Twice around the trunk, with a bow on top.

**4**



### *Brick the Wheels*

One brick in front of a tire and one behind.

**5**



### *Watch It Hold*

When the beam comes, the car will bob like a balloon but stay put.



**6** ### *Untie It for Errands*

Remember to untie it before you drive to the store. Your husband did not.

## NOTES

A bow in the rope looks festive and is easier to undo with gloves on.

**IMPORTANT**

Never stay in the car during a beam. Groceries can be replaced; you cannot.

HOW TO

# KEEPING THE LAWN SAUCER-FREE

SKILL 13 · SAUCER-PROOFING THE HOME · 1 HOUR · EASY

*A saucer parked on the front lawn kills the grass and lowers the tone of the street. A short mow, a polite sign and a sprinkler keep them moving along.*

1



*Mow It Short*

Saucers prefer long, soft grass to land on. Give them none.

2



*Paint a Sign*

'No Landing. Visitors Please Use the Street.' Be polite but clear.

3

*Hammer It In*

Place it where it can be seen from above.



4



*Run the Sprinkler*

Nothing from space likes a wet bottom.

5



*Sit and Watch*

Take a lawn chair and some lemonade, and wave them along.

6



*Shoo the Stragglers*

If one lands anyway, a broom and a firm 'Shoo!' usually do the trick.

## NOTES

Leave the Hendersons' lawn unmowed. Let them have the saucer.

**IMPORTANT**

Never mow around a landed saucer. They are very sensitive about their paint.

## MATERIALS

- A push mower



- A garden sprinkler



- A hand-painted sign



- A hammer



- A lawn chair



HOW TO

# MAKING YOUR HOUSE LOOK BORING FROM ABOVE

SKILL 14 · SAUCER-PROOFING THE HOME · HALF A DAY · MEDIUM

*Visitors look for the brightest, most interesting house on the street. With a gray tarpaulin, a can of beige paint and a sleepy expression, yours will be passed right by.*

## MATERIALS


A gray tarpaulin


A can of beige paint


A paintbrush


A ladder


A plain doormat

1



*Pull Up the Pink Flamingos*

They are a beacon to every galaxy.

2



*Paint the Door Beige*

Nobody has ever invaded a beige house.

3



*Cover the Swing Set*

A tarp hides the most exciting thing in your yard.

4



*Turn Off the Porch Light*

Bright lights say 'come in'. Dark porches say 'nobody home'.

5



*Look Sleepy at the Window*

If a saucer hovers, yawn widely. They will move on.



6 *Watch Them Pick the Neighbors*

The Hendersons' new aluminum siding is far more interesting.

## NOTES

Put the flamingos back after the invasion. Life is too short for beige.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't make your house so boring that the mailman skips it too.

CHAPTER THREE

3

# ENTERTAINING VISITORS FROM BEYOND

*Gracious hospitality for guests with more than two arms*







Sooner or later, one of them is going to ring the doorbell. A good hostess does not scream, faint or hide in the coat closet. She opens the door, smiles, and asks whether they would like a cup of coffee. This chapter covers everything from the first hello to the last wave goodbye, including how to seat a guest who is mostly tentacle.

IN THIS CHAPTER


15 Answering the Door to an Alien
16 Setting the Table for a Guest With Seven Arms
17 Making Small Talk With a Martian
18 Hosting a Bridge Party With Visitors
19 Seating a Guest Who Won't Fit on the Sofa
20 Serving Coffee to Something With No Mouth
21 Saying Goodbye Without Being Abducted

HOW TO

# ANSWERING THE DOOR TO AN ALIEN

SKILL 15 · ENTERTAINING VISITORS FROM BEYOND · 5 MINUTES · EASY

## MATERIALS

- A fresh apron (to take off)



- Lipstick



- A welcome mat



- A small dish of mints



- A calm voice



*First impressions matter, on this planet and others. Open the door the way your mother taught you: with a smile, a straight back and your apron off.*

1



### *Check Your Lipstick*

A quick look in the hall mirror. Visitors from Venus notice these things.

2



### *Take Off the Apron*

Hang it on the hook. You are now a hostess.

3

### *Peek Through the Glass*

Count the eyes so you can make proper eye contact.



4



### *Open With a Smile*

Wide, warm and not too many teeth. Some species find teeth alarming.

5



### *Say Good Afternoon*

Speak slowly. Most of them learned English from the radio.

6



### *Invite Them In*

'Won't you come in? Mind the step.' Then step aside, quickly.

## NOTES

Keep a dish of mints by the door. Interplanetary breath can be strong.

**IMPORTANT**

Never say 'Take me to your leader.' That's their line.

HOW TO

# SETTING THE TABLE FOR A GUEST WITH SEVEN ARMS

SKILL 16 · ENTERTAINING VISITORS FROM BEYOND · 30 MINUTES · MEDIUM

*Emily Post says nothing about tentacles, so the modern hostess must improvise. The secret is extra forks and plenty of napkins.*

1



*Count the Arms*

Ask politely. One fork per arm is the rule.

2



*Lay the Tablecloth*

Use the washable one. Trust us.

3



*Fan the Forks*

Arrange them like a sunburst around the plate. Very modern.

MATERIALS


Your best tablecloth


Twenty-one forks


A stack of napkins


A centerpiece


Place cards

4



*Double the Napkins*

Visitors drip. Some of them on purpose.

5



*Add a Centerpiece*

Flowers are nice, but some guests eat them. Choose something sturdy, like a pineapple.

## NOTES

A lazy Susan is a godsend. Guests can reach everything without stretching across the gravy.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't seat a visitor next to the goldfish bowl.



6 *Seat Your Guest*

Pull out the sturdiest chair and put a cushion on it.

HOW TO

# MAKING SMALL TALK WITH A MARTIAN

SKILL 17 · ENTERTAINING VISITORS FROM BEYOND · 20 MINUTES · EASY

*Conversation is the hostess's most important tool. With a few good topics you can chat with anyone from anywhere, even a place with three moons.*

## MATERIALS

- A list of topics



- A pot of coffee



- Two good cups



- The family photo album



- A globe



1



### *Start With the Weather*

Ask about theirs. On Mars it is always cold and dusty, so be sympathetic.

2



### *Show the Globe*

Point out where you live. They will point out where they parked.

### *Ask About the Trip*

'Was the traffic bad?' works with every visitor.

3



4



### *Show the Photo Album*

Baby pictures are a universal language.

5



### *Avoid Politics*

Never ask what they think of the President. They may want to meet him.

6



### *Laugh at Their Jokes*

Even if you don't understand them. Especially then.

## NOTES

Most visitors are fascinated by the vacuum cleaner. A short demonstration fills twenty minutes.

**IMPORTANT**

Never ask how old they are. Some of them are four thousand.

HOW TO

# HOSTING A BRIDGE PARTY WITH VISITORS

SKILL 18 · ENTERTAINING VISITORS FROM BEYOND · AN AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

*Bridge needs four, and when Doris has the flu, any visitor will do. Many of them are excellent at cards, since they can see right through them.*

1



*Set Up the Table*

Four chairs and one wide stool.

2



*Explain the Rules*

Speak slowly and show them a trick or two.

3



*Watch for Peeking*

Ask guests with eyes on stalks to keep them above the table.

MATERIALS


A card table


Two decks of cards


A bowl of nuts


Score pads


Tea sandwiches

4



*Pass the Sandwiches*

Cut off the crusts. Some species are allergic to crust.

5



*Keep Score*

Write neatly. They will check.

## NOTES

Never play for money. They use a different currency, and it glows.

**IMPORTANT**

If a guest has seven arms, count the cards before and after.



6 *Lose Graciously*

They will win. Smile and offer more nuts.

HOW TO

# SEATING A GUEST WHO WON'T FIT ON THE SOFA

SKILL 19 · ENTERTAINING VISITORS FROM BEYOND · 30 MINUTES · MEDIUM

*Some visitors are the size of a Buick. A good hostess never makes a guest feel large. She simply moves the furniture.*

## MATERIALS

- A tape measure



- Extra cushions



- A rubber sheet



- A plant mister



- A footstool



1



*Measure the Guest*

Discreetly. Pretend you are measuring for drapes.

2



*Push Back the Sofa*

Slide it to the wall. Lift with your knees.

3

*Lay the Rubber Sheet*

Large guests are often damp. Your rug will thank you.



4



*Pile the Cushions*

Make a nice soft nest.

5



*Invite Them to Settle*

'Make yourself comfortable.' They will.

6



*Mist Them Now and Then*

Damp visitors like to stay damp. A plant mister is very hospitable.

## NOTES

If the guest won't fit through the door, serve tea on the lawn.

**IMPORTANT**

Never sit on a blob to see if it's comfortable. It is, but it's rude.

HOW TO

# SERVING COFFEE TO SOMETHING WITH NO MOUTH

SKILL 20 · ENTERTAINING VISITORS FROM BEYOND · 15 MINUTES · EASY

*Not every visitor has a mouth where you'd expect one. Some drink through their feet. Some soak it up through the skin. A good hostess serves the coffee anyway and lets the guest work it out.*

1



*Perk the Coffee*

Fresh and strong. Visitors travel a long way.

2



*Offer Cream and Sugar*

Ask how they take it and write it down for next time.

3



*Offer a Straw*

If you can't find the mouth, a straw lets them find it themselves.

MATERIALS



A percolator



Your good cups



A saucer (the small kind)



A drinking straw



Sugar cubes

4



*Try the Saucer*

Some guests prefer to soak a tentacle. Pour a little in the saucer.

5



*Don't Stare*

However they drink it, look at the cookies instead.

## NOTES

If the coffee disappears and the guest looks happy, it worked.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't offer decaf. It confuses them.



6 *Refill Promptly*

An empty cup is a sad cup on any planet.

HOW TO

# SAYING GOODBYE WITHOUT BEING ABDUCTED

SKILL 21 · ENTERTAINING VISITORS FROM BEYOND · 10 MINUTES · MEDIUM

## MATERIALS

- A wrapped plate of leftovers



- A handkerchief for waving



- A porch light



- Sensible shoes



- A firm handshake



*The end of a visit is delicate. Many a hostess has walked a guest to the saucer and found herself on the way to Jupiter. Here is how to wave goodbye from a safe distance.*

1



*Wrap Up Leftovers*

Every guest leaves with a plate. That is the law in this house.

2



*Walk Them to the Porch*

Not one step farther.

3

*Shake Hands Firmly*

One firm shake, then step back.



4



*Stay Off the Ramp*

If a ramp comes down, admire it from the porch.

5



*Wave the Handkerchief*

Big waves. They can't see well in our atmosphere.

6



*Turn Off the Porch Light*

The visit is over. The dishes are waiting.

## NOTES

Invite them back for Thursday. Nothing ends a visit faster than a firm date for the next one.

**IMPORTANT**

If the beam starts glowing, hold on to the porch railing.

CHAPTER FOUR

4

# FEEDING THE INVADERS

*Recipes and kitchen wisdom for appetites from outer space*







Everyone gets hungry after crossing the galaxy, and an army marches on its stomach, even an army with nine stomachs each. The kitchen is where the housewife wins the war of the worlds, one casserole at a time. These recipes stretch to feed any number of guests and have been tested on visitors from at least four planets. Not one of them has invaded anybody after second helpings.

IN THIS CHAPTER


22 Tuna Casserole for Forty Mouths
23 The Peacekeeping Green Gelatin Mold
24 Meatloaf Diplomacy
25 Packing a Lunch for a Long Space Voyage
26 Baking a Welcome-to-Earth Cake
27 Feeding a Visitor Who Eats Metal

HOW TO

# TUNA CASSEROLE FOR FORTY MOUTHS

SKILL 22 · FEEDING THE INVADERS · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

*Some visitors have one mouth. Some have forty. This casserole feeds them all and still leaves enough for your husband's lunch.*

## MATERIALS


Twelve cans of tuna


Egg noodles


Cream of mushroom soup


Crushed potato chips


Your biggest roasting pan

1



*Boil the Noodles*

Use the canning pot. You will need it.

2



*Open the Tuna*

All twelve cans. Save the juice for the cat.

3



*Stir In the Soup*

Mix until creamy and hum something cheerful.

4



*Top With Chips*

Crush them with a rolling pin. Very satisfying.

5



*Bake Until Bubbly*

Forty-five minutes at 350. The smell will bring guests from miles away.



6 *Serve Generously*

One scoop per mouth.

## NOTES

If the guest eats the pan too, take it as a compliment.

**IMPORTANT**

Check for little ones under the table before you set the hot dish down.

HOW TO

# THE PEACEKEEPING GREEN GELATIN MOLD

SKILL 23 · FEEDING THE INVADERS · OVERNIGHT · EASY

*Scientists have proven what housewives always knew: everybody loves a jiggly gelatin mold. Visitors seem to think it is a relative and greet it warmly.*

1



*Dissolve the Gelatin*

Boiling water, stirred until no crystals remain.

2



*Add the Fruit*

Fruit cocktail is traditional. Cherries on top are festive.

3

*Pour Into the Mold*

Slowly, so the fruit stays put.



4



*Chill Overnight*

Put it on the top shelf where nobody can poke it.

5



*Turn It Out*

Dip the mold in warm water, flip it over and hope.

6



*Present It Proudly*

Watch your guest's eyes light up. All of them.

## NOTES

If the gelatin waves back, that is not your gelatin.

**IMPORTANT**

Never serve green gelatin to a green visitor without asking first. It may be a cousin.

## MATERIALS

- Lime gelatin



- A ring mold



- Canned fruit cocktail



- Whipped cream



- A pretty platter



HOW TO

# MEATLOAF DIPLOMACY

SKILL 24 · FEEDING THE INVADERS · 1.5 HOURS · EASY

*Many an invasion has ended at the dinner table. A good meatloaf, glazed and sliced thick, says 'Welcome to Earth' better than any general ever could.*

## MATERIALS


Two pounds of ground beef


Bread crumbs


An egg


Ketchup for the glaze


A loaf pan

1



*Mix With Your Hands*

It is the only way. Take your rings off first.

2



*Shape the Loaf*

Pat it into the pan, firm but gentle.

3



*Glaze With Ketchup*

A thick red stripe. Visitors find it very pretty.

4



*Bake for an Hour*

Set the timer. Do not answer the door until it rings.

5



*Slice It Thick*

Thin slices look stingy on any planet.



6 *Serve the Ambassador*

Give the biggest guest the end piece. It is an honor.

## NOTES

Leftover meatloaf makes the best sandwiches for the long trip home to Neptune.

**IMPORTANT**

If the visitor asks what's in it, say 'love'.

HOW TO

# PACKING A LUNCH FOR A LONG SPACE VOYAGE

SKILL 25 · FEEDING THE INVADERS · 20 MINUTES · EASY

*It is a long way to Alpha Centauri and there are no diners on the way. Send your visitor off with a proper lunch.*

1



*Make the Sandwiches*
Peanut butter travels well in zero gravity.

2



*Wrap in Wax Paper*
Tight folds, so crumbs don't float around the cabin.

3

*Fill the Thermos*
Hot tomato soup. Space is chilly.



4



*Add a Note*
'Have a safe trip! Love from Earth.'

5



*Close the Pail*
Snap the latches and check them twice.

6



*Hand It Over*
They are so touched that some of them cry. It comes out green.

## NOTES

Pack an extra cookie. Space voyages always take longer than planned.

**IMPORTANT**

No hard-boiled eggs. Not in a sealed saucer.

## MATERIALS

- A metal lunch pail



- Wax paper



- Peanut butter sandwiches



- A thermos of soup



- An apple



HOW TO

# BAKING A WELCOME-TO-EARTH CAKE

SKILL 26 · FEEDING THE INVADERS · 2 HOURS · MEDIUM

*Nothing says hello like a three-layer cake. Decorate it like a planet and you will have friends for life, however long life is where they come from.*

## MATERIALS


Flour, sugar and eggs


Three round cake pans


Blue and green frosting


Birthday candles


A cake stand

1



*Mix the Batter*

Cream the butter and sugar until fluffy.

2



*Bake Three Layers*

Turn the pans halfway. Ovens are like planets: hot on one side.

3



*Stack the Layers*

Frosting between each one, like mortar.

4



*Frost It Like a Globe*

Blue for the oceans, green for the land. Don't forget your town.

5



*Light the Candles*

One for each planet in the solar system.



6 *Present It With a Song*

'For He's a Jolly Good Fellow' is understood everywhere.

## NOTES

Save a slice for the President. He may stop by.

**IMPORTANT**

Some visitors try to eat the candles. Blow them out first.

HOW TO

# FEEDING A VISITOR WHO EATS METAL

SKILL 27 · FEEDING THE INVADERS · 30 MINUTES · MEDIUM

*Not every guest eats meatloaf. Some prefer hubcaps, bedsprings and the occasional toaster. With a little planning you can feed them without losing the station wagon.*

1



*Raid the Garage*

Old paint cans and broken rakes make a lovely buffet.

2



*Polish the Pans*

Shiny food tastes better. Ask anyone from Mercury.

3

*Arrange the Plate*

Bottle caps make a nice garnish.



4



*Hide the Toaster*

Put it in the oven until dinner is over.

5



*Serve and Stand Back*

They crunch. Loudly.

6



*Count the Spoons Afterward*

It isn't stealing. It's dessert.

## NOTES

The junkyard on Route 9 sells scrap by the pound. Much cheaper than steak.

**IMPORTANT**

Never let them near the car. They start with the chrome.

## MATERIALS

- Old pots and pans



- A bag of bottle caps



- Rusty nails



- A tin plate



- A fork (theirs, not yours)



CHAPTER FIVE

5

# HOUSEKEEPING IN A TIME OF INVASION

*Getting slime out of the shag and other modern problems*







Visitors are messy. They drip, they glow, they shed, and some of them leave little puddles that hum. But the American housewife has faced grass stains, gravy and three boys. She can face this. Here are the tried and tested methods for keeping a spotless home during an invasion, along with a few ways to get the visitors to help.

IN THIS CHAPTER


28 Getting Alien Slime Out of the Carpet
29 Laundering a Space Suit
30 Vacuuming Up a Very Small Alien (and Letting It Out)
31 Polishing a Flying Saucer
32 Defrosting the Kitchen After a Freeze Ray
33 Putting a Many-Armed Visitor to Work
34 Getting Ray-Gun Scorch Marks Off the Wallpaper

HOW TO

# GETTING ALIEN SLIME OUT OF THE CARPET

SKILL 28 · HOUSEKEEPING IN A TIME OF INVASION · 30 MINUTES · MEDIUM

*Green slime is the gravy of the space age: it gets everywhere, and it never comes out the first time.*

1



*Blot, Don't Rub*

Rubbing spreads it. Blotting lifts it.

2



*Mix Vinegar and Water*

One cup to a bucket. Your mother's recipe.

3



*Scrub in Circles*

Small circles, working outward.

## MATERIALS



A bucket of warm water



White vinegar



A scrub brush



Old towels



Rubber gloves

4



*Rinse and Blot Again*

Repeat until the towel comes up white.

5



*Find the Source*

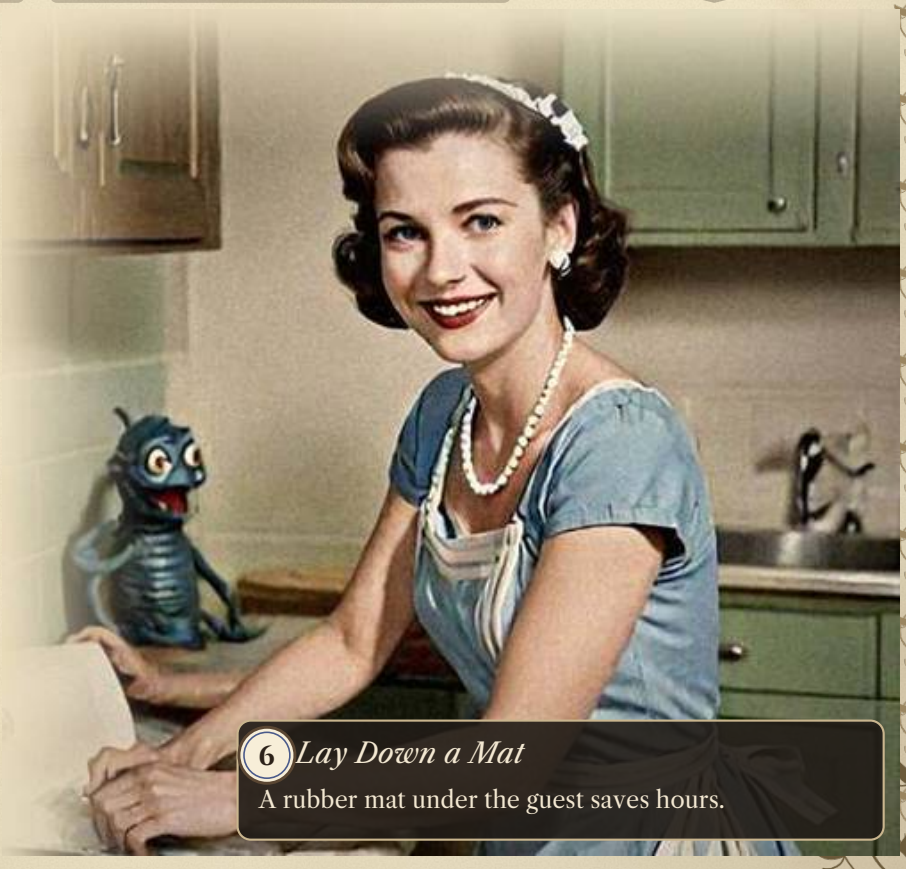
The trail usually leads to the sofa.

## NOTES

Slime that glows in the dark is easiest to find at night. Clean with the lights off.

**IMPORTANT**

Never vacuum slime. The vacuum will never be the same, and neither will you.



6 *Lay Down a Mat*

A rubber mat under the guest saves hours.

HOW TO

# LAUNDERING A SPACE SUIT

SKILL 29 · HOUSEKEEPING IN A TIME OF INVASION · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

*Silver space suits are very smart, but they show every spot. Cold water and a gentle hand keep them shining.*

## MATERIALS

- Mild soap flakes



- A washtub



- A clothesline



- Clothespins



- A soft brush



**1**



*Check the Pockets*

You'll find rocks, odd coins and sometimes a small creature.

**2**



*Soak in Cold Water*

Hot water shrinks them to doll size.

**3**

*Brush the Cuffs*

Moon dust gathers at the wrists.



**4**



*Wring Gently*

Twist, don't yank.

**5**



*Hang It in the Sun*

Pin it by the shoulders. It will try to float.

**6**



*Return It Pressed*

A warm iron on low. Never steam the helmet.

## NOTES

A little starch makes the collar stand up. Visitors love a crisp collar.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't put the helmet in the dryer. The Hendersons did, and it is still going round.

HOW TO

# VACUUMING UP A VERY SMALL ALIEN (AND LETTING IT OUT)

SKILL 30 · HOUSEKEEPING IN A TIME OF INVASION · 15 MINUTES · EASY

*It happens to the best of us. You're running the vacuum, you hear a tiny 'Eep!', and now there is a visitor in the bag. Don't panic. Here is how to get them out with their dignity.*

1



*Switch Off at Once*

Pull the plug. Don't just push the button.

2



*Listen for Squeaking*

Put your ear to the bag.

3



*Spread the Newspaper*

Gently empty the bag onto the funnies.

MATERIALS



Your vacuum cleaner



A sheet of newspaper



A magnifying glass



A thimble of water



An apology

4



*Search With a Glass*

Look for anything blinking.

5



*Offer Water*

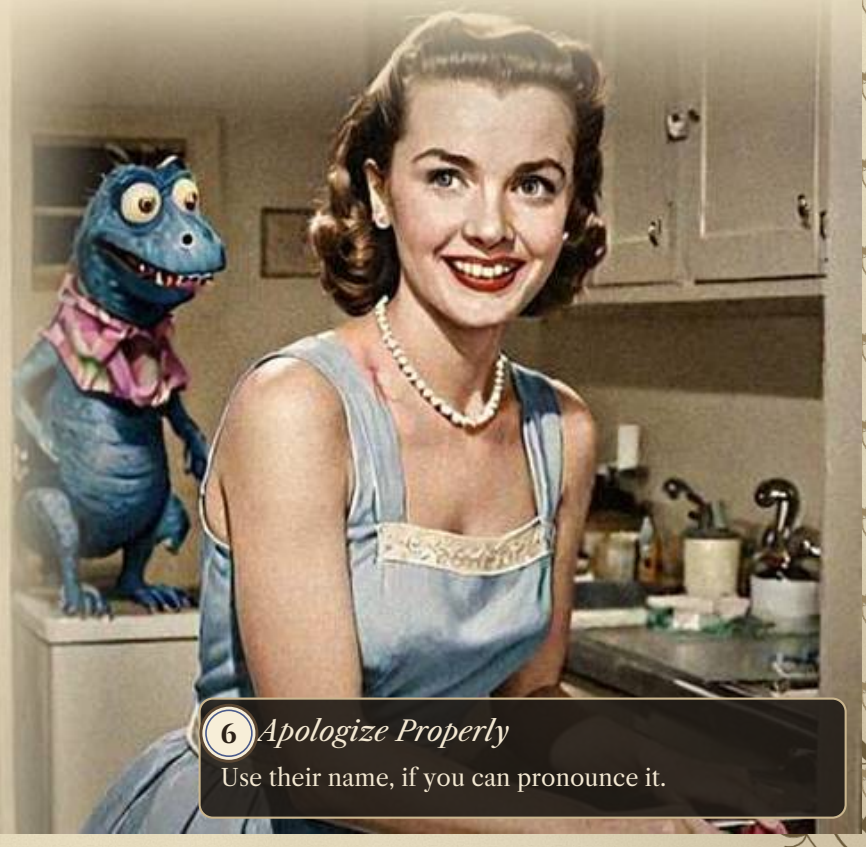
A thimble is plenty. They are very small.

## NOTES

Vacuum under the beds slowly. That is where they like to nap.

**IMPORTANT**

Never use the hose attachment on the sofa cushions during an invasion.



6 *Apologize Properly*

Use their name, if you can pronounce it.

HOW TO

# POLISHING A FLYING SAUCER

SKILL 31 · HOUSEKEEPING IN A TIME OF INVASION · 2 HOURS · MEDIUM

*If one is going to sit on your lawn all week, it might as well be shiny. A polished saucer reflects well on the whole household.*

## MATERIALS

- Chrome polish



- Soft rags



- A stepladder



- A bucket of soapy water



- A chamois



1



*Ask Permission*

Knock on the hatch. Some of them are fussy.

2



*Wash Off the Space Dust*

Soapy water and long strokes.

3

*Climb the Ladder*

Do the dome last. That is where the bird droppings are.



4



*Apply the Polish*

Small circles, then buff.

5



*Admire the Shine*

You should see your reflection, hairnet and all.

6



*Decline the Thank-You Ride*

Politely say no, unless it's going to the shops.

## NOTES

Car wax works too, and it costs half as much.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't touch the glowing bits. They are hot, and some of them are looking at you.

HOW TO

# DEFROSTING THE KITCHEN AFTER A FREEZE RAY

SKILL 32 · HOUSEKEEPING IN A TIME OF INVASION · 1 HOUR · EASY

*A freeze ray is no worse than a stuck freezer door, really. Something in your kitchen is now covered in frost. With a hair dryer and patience it will be good as new.*

1



*Assess the Damage*
Is it the cat, the casserole or your husband?

2



*Plug In the Hair Dryer*
Medium heat. You're thawing, not cooking.

3



*Lay Towels Down*
Everything drips eventually.

MATERIALS


A hair dryer


Towels


A kettle of warm water


A flannel blanket


A cup of cocoa

4



*Thaw the Casserole*
Into a warm oven. Supper is saved.

5



*Wrap the Cat*
A flannel blanket and a saucer of warm milk.

## NOTES

Keep the ice. Freeze-ray ice keeps lemonade cold for a week.

**IMPORTANT**

Never thaw your husband with the hair dryer on high.



6 *Make Cocoa All Round*
Including for the visitor, who is very sorry.

HOW TO

# PUTTING A MANY-ARMED VISITOR TO WORK

SKILL 33 · HOUSEKEEPING IN A TIME OF INVASION · AN AFTERNOON · EASY

*Many visitors have six or eight arms and nothing to do. Put them to work. A many-armed guest can fold a week of laundry before the kettle boils.*

## MATERIALS

- A basket of laundry



- An ironing board



- A feather duster



- A mop



- A gold star chart



1



### *Show Them the Basket*

Hold up a towel and fold it slowly. Then point at them.

2



### *Hand Out the Tools*

A duster in one hand, a mop in another, and so on.

3

### *Teach the Ironing*

Show them how to test the iron with a damp finger, or tentacle.



4



### *Supervise the Dusting*

Make sure they reach the top of the bookcase. They can.

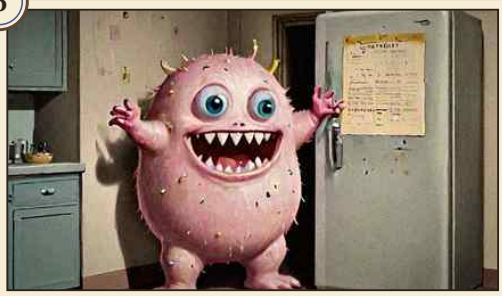
5



### *Check the Folding*

Corners should meet. Praise generously.

6



### *Give a Gold Star*

Visitors love gold stars. Put the chart on the icebox.

## NOTES

Don't let them wash the good crystal until the third week.

**IMPORTANT**

Some visitors fold everything, including the dog. Supervise closely.

HOW TO

# GETTING RAY-GUN SCORCH MARKS OFF THE WALLPAPER

SKILL 34 · HOUSEKEEPING IN A TIME OF INVASION · 30 MINUTES · MEDIUM

*Even friendly visitors are clumsy with their equipment. A scorch mark on the floral wallpaper looks dreadful, but it comes off with a little bread and patience.*

1



*Find the Mark*

Usually at the height of a nervous tentacle.

2



*Rub With Bread*

An old trick: fresh white bread lifts soot like magic.

3



*Try Baking Soda*

Make a paste and dab it on with a damp sponge.

MATERIALS


A slice of white bread


Baking soda


A damp sponge


Wallpaper paste


A spare roll of wallpaper

4



*Patch If Needed*

Cut a piece from the spare roll and match the roses.

5



*Hang a Picture Over It*

When all else fails, a nice landscape.

## NOTES

Buy an extra roll of wallpaper whenever you redecorate. Invasions are not rare.

**IMPORTANT**

Never try to clean the ray gun yourself.



6 *Have a Word With the Guest*

Gently suggest the ray gun stays in the saucer.

CHAPTER SIX

6

# CHILDREN, PETS AND LITTLE GREEN MEN

*What to do when the kids bring one home*







Children and visitors get along famously. They are about the same height, they both like bright colors, and neither of them wants to take a bath. This chapter covers what to do when Junior brings one home, how to mind a baby from beyond, how to walk a space pet and how to keep the dog from barking at the sky all night.

IN THIS CHAPTER


35 When Junior Brings One Home
36 Babysitting a Baby From Beyond
37 Walking a Space Pet
38 Calming a Dog Who Barks at Saucers
39 Explaining Aliens at Bedtime
40 Sewing a Halloween Costume Nobody Will Question

HOW TO

# WHEN JUNIOR BRINGS ONE HOME

SKILL 35 · CHILDREN, PETS AND LITTLE GREEN MEN · 1 HOUR · EASY

*'Can we keep him, Mom? He followed me home!' Every mother hears it sooner or later. Sometimes it's a puppy. Sometimes it has antennae.*

1



*Hear the Story*

Let Junior explain. It will take a while.

2



*Meet the Visitor*

Look it over and count its legs.

3

*Make Up a Bed*

A cardboard box and an old blanket by the furnace.



4



*Set the House Rules*

No flying in the house. No beaming the cat.

5



*Feed It Supper*

Start with mashed potatoes. Everybody likes mashed potatoes.

6



*Look for Its Parents*

Somewhere out there, a mother saucer is worried sick.

## NOTES

If its parents come for it, invite them in for coffee. They will have had a long night.

**IMPORTANT**

Never let Junior take it to school for show-and-tell. Not after last time.

## MATERIALS

- A cardboard box



- An old blanket



- A bowl of mashed potatoes



- Junior's promise to look after it



- A list of house rules



HOW TO

# BABYSITTING A BABY FROM BEYOND

SKILL 36 · CHILDREN, PETS AND LITTLE GREEN MEN · AN EVENING · MEDIUM

*Visiting mothers need a night out too. If you are asked to mind the little one, treat it like any baby: feed it, burp it and keep it away from the electrical sockets.*

## MATERIALS


A bassinet


A baby bottle


A rattle


A soft blanket


A lullaby

1



*Take the Instructions*

Write down when it eats and what it eats.

2



*Warm the Bottle*

Test it on your wrist. If it glows, it's too hot.

3



*Feed the Baby*

Some have one mouth and some have six. Be patient.

4



*Shake the Rattle*

They love noise. Lots of noise.

5



*Burp It Gently*

Over the shoulder with a towel. Stand clear.



6 *Sing a Lullaby*

'Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star' may make it homesick, so try 'Rock-a-Bye Baby'.

## NOTES

Floating babies should be tied to the bassinet with a ribbon.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't change it until you know which end is which.

HOW TO

# WALKING A SPACE PET

SKILL 37 · CHILDREN, PETS AND LITTLE GREEN MEN · 30 MINUTES · EASY

*Some visitors bring pets, and pets need walking. A space pet is like a dog, only with more legs and less interest in fire hydrants.*

1



*Clip on the Leash*

Find the neck. There may be more than one.

2



*Start Down the Sidewalk*

Let it sniff. Everything is new.

3

*Say Hello to the Neighbors*

Smile. It's just a pet.



4



*Keep It Off the Lawns*

It eats grass. A lot of grass.

5



*Give a Treat*

Reward good behavior with a dog biscuit.

6



*Head Home Before Dark*

They glow at night, and it frightens the Wilsons.

## NOTES

If it floats away, just hold on. It comes down eventually.

**IMPORTANT**

Steer clear of the Pruitts' poodle. It has never been the same.

## MATERIALS

- A long leash



- A sturdy collar



- Dog biscuits



- A paper bag (for what they leave)



- Comfortable shoes



HOW TO

# CALMING A DOG WHO BARKS AT SAUCERS

SKILL 38 · CHILDREN, PETS AND LITTLE GREEN MEN · 1 HOUR · EASY

*Dogs know. They have known all along. Every night Rusty stands on the lawn barking at the sky, and every night the neighbors complain. Here is how to give everyone some peace.*

## MATERIALS


Dog biscuits


A soft dog bed


A ticking clock


Earmuffs (for you)


A tennis ball

1



*Find Out What He Sees*

Look where he's looking. He is usually right.

2



*Bring Him Inside*

Lay a biscuit trail from the lawn to the kitchen.

3



*Make a Cozy Bed*

A ticking clock under the blanket sounds like a heartbeat.

4



*Draw the Curtains*

If he can't see them, he'll stop.

5



*Throw the Ball*

A good game takes his mind off the sky.



6 *Introduce Him to the Visitor*

Once they meet, they are usually friends.

## NOTES

Dogs and visitors both like belly rubs. Find out where the belly is first.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't let him chase the saucer. He'll never catch it, and if he does, he'll never let go.

HOW TO

# EXPLAINING ALIENS AT BEDTIME

SKILL 39 · CHILDREN, PETS AND LITTLE GREEN MEN · 15 MINUTES · EASY

*Little ones have questions. Where do they come from? Are they nice? Is that one under my bed? A calm mother with a good story can answer them all.*

1



*Tuck Them In*
Tight sheets make for brave children.

2



*Read About the Stars*
Show them the pictures of the planets.

3

*Check Under the Bed*
With a flashlight. Make a show of it.



4



*Find a Visitor Anyway*
Sometimes there really is one. Say hello and ask it to sleep in the hall.

5



*Turn On the Night-Light*
A little glow keeps everyone calm.

6



*Kiss Goodnight*
And leave the door open just a crack.

## NOTES

Tell them visitors are afraid of children who don't brush their teeth. It isn't true, but it works.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't mention the one in the attic until morning.

## MATERIALS

- A picture book about the stars



- A night-light



- A glass of water



- A teddy bear



- A flashlight



HOW TO

# SEWING A HALLOWEEN COSTUME NOBODY WILL QUESTION

SKILL 40 · CHILDREN, PETS AND LITTLE GREEN MEN · AN AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

*Halloween is the one night a visitor can walk down the street without causing a fuss. One old bedsheet and nobody will look twice.*

## MATERIALS


A sewing machine


An old bedsheet


A cowboy hat


Scissors


A trick-or-treat bag

1



*Measure the Visitor*

Hold still. Yes, all the arms.

2



*Cut the Sheet*

Cut the eyeholes. Count the eyes first.

3



*Sew the Hems*

A straight stitch so it doesn't trip.

4



*Add a Cowboy Hat*

Everybody loves a cowboy.

5



*Practice 'Trick or Treat'*

Three words. It may take an hour.



6 *Send Them Out*

Back by eight, and no beaming candy out of other children's bags.

## NOTES

It has won the costume contest three years running. Nobody has guessed.

**IMPORTANT**

Keep it away from the apple-bobbing tub. Some of them dissolve.

CHAPTER SEVEN

7

# OUT AND ABOUT

*Shopping, errands and the beauty parlor during an invasion*







An invasion is no reason to let the errands pile up. The library books are still due, the supermarket still has a sale on pot roast, and your hair still needs setting on Friday. This chapter takes the housewife out into town, where the saucers are parked in the loading zones and the visitors are trying on hats.

IN THIS CHAPTER


41 Grocery Shopping During an Invasion
42 Getting Your Hair Set Next to a Martian
43 Taking a Visitor to the Public Library
44 Bringing a Visitor to the PTA Meeting
45 A Church Picnic With Unexpected Guests
46 League Night With a Tentacled Bowler
47 Buying a Hat for a Head Shaped Like That

HOW TO

# GROCERY SHOPPING DURING AN INVASION

SKILL 41 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 HOUR · EASY

*The supermarket is busier than ever. Everybody is stocking up, and half the shoppers have tentacles. Keep your list short and your cart close.*

## MATERIALS

- A shopping list



- Coupons



- Your handbag



- A sturdy shopping cart



- Exact change



1



*Make a List*

Tinned goods, milk, and something nice for the visitors.

2



*Get a Good Cart*

One with all four wheels pointing the same way.

3

*Mind the Aisles*

Visitors stop suddenly to marvel at the canned peas.



4



*Watch Your Cart*

They will put things in it. Check before the register.

5



*Check Out Politely*

Count your change. Some coins are not from here.

6



*Carry It Home Carefully*

Eggs on top.

## NOTES

Go on Tuesday mornings. Visitors sleep late.

**IMPORTANT**

If a visitor squeezes the melons, look away. That is how they say hello.

HOW TO

# GETTING YOUR HAIR SET NEXT TO A MARTIAN

SKILL 42 · OUT AND ABOUT · 2 HOURS · EASY

*Friday is hair day, invasion or not. These days the chair next to you at the beauty parlor may be taken by someone with antennae, and they will want curlers too.*

1



*Keep Your Appointment*
Never cancel. They will give your slot away.

2



*Sit Under the Dryer*
Thirty minutes with a good magazine.

3



*Greet Your Neighbor*
Nod to the visitor in the next chair and compliment the curlers.

MATERIALS


Your appointment card


A headscarf


A magazine


A tip for the stylist

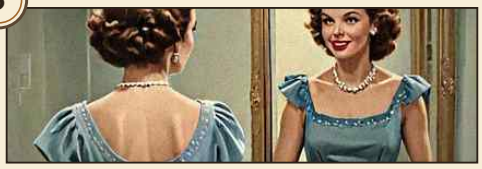

Bobby pins

4



*Don't Stare at the Antennae*
Keep your eyes on your magazine.

5



*Check the Result*
Turn your head both ways in the mirror.

## NOTES

Bring a scarf for the walk home. Saucer wind is murder on a set.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't let the visitor use your dryer first. It will never cool down.



6 *Tip and Go*
A quarter for the girl and a smile for everyone.

HOW TO

# TAKING A VISITOR TO THE PUBLIC LIBRARY

SKILL 43 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 HOUR · EASY

*Visitors are curious about everything, and the public library is the best place to learn. Take one along. Just remind them to whisper.*

## MATERIALS

- Your library card



- A tote bag



- Coins for overdue fines



- A finger to put to your lips



- Reading glasses



**1**



*Return Your Books*

Pay your fines. Librarians notice these things.

**2**



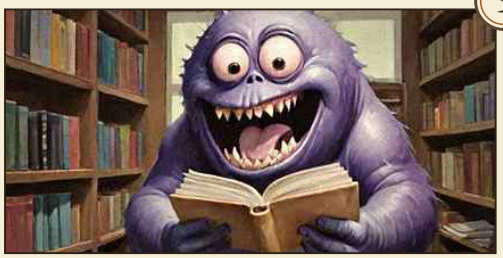
*Find the Astronomy Shelf*

They always want to see pictures of home.

**3**

*Whisper*

Put a finger to your lips. They catch on quickly.



**4**



*Find a Cookbook for Yourself*

You'll need new recipes for all these guests.

**5**



*Get Them a Card*

Many libraries will issue one with a forwarding address.

**6**



*Carry Home the Stack*

Visitors check out the limit. Every time.

## NOTES

Steer them away from the science fiction shelf. They find it very insulting.

**IMPORTANT**

Never let them borrow the encyclopedia volume on Earth's defenses.

HOW TO

# BRINGING A VISITOR TO THE PTA MEETING

SKILL 44 · OUT AND ABOUT · AN EVENING · MEDIUM

*Visitors with children want a say in the bake sale too, and the PTA is the place to say it. Bring them along and help them follow the rules of order.*

1



*Bring Brownies*
The first rule of the PTA.

2



*Make Name Tags*
'Hello, My Name Is...' Leave plenty of room.

3



*Find Good Seats*
Near the coffee urn, far from Mrs. Pruitt.

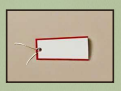
MATERIALS


A folding chair


A plate of brownies


The meeting agenda


A pencil


A name tag

4



*Raise Your Hand*
Show the visitor how. One tentacle is plenty.

5



*Vote on the Bake Sale*
Visitors always vote for more cookies.

## NOTES

Volunteer the visitor for the bake sale. Eight arms can frost a great many cupcakes.

**IMPORTANT**

Never let a visitor take the minutes. They write in a language that hums.



6 *Stack the Chairs*
Everyone helps, even guests.

HOW TO

# A CHURCH PICNIC WITH UNEXPECTED GUESTS

SKILL 45 · OUT AND ABOUT · AN AFTERNOON · EASY

*There is always room for one more at the church picnic, even if that one is nine feet tall and green. Bring an extra casserole and a big blanket.*

## MATERIALS

- A checked picnic blanket



- Fried chicken



- Deviled eggs



- Lemonade



- A wicker basket



1



*Spread the Blanket*
In the shade, away from the anthill.

2



*Unpack the Basket*
Chicken, eggs, pie. In that order.

*Welcome the Newcomer*
Hand them a plate.

3



4



*Pass the Deviled Eggs*
Visitors adore them. Count on six each.

5



*Join the Sack Race*
They have an advantage with no legs. Be a good sport.

6



*Pack Up Tidy*
Leave the park cleaner than you found it.

## NOTES

Seat visitors upwind of the potato salad. Some of them smell faintly of thunderstorms.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't let them near the punch bowl. They think it's a bath.

HOW TO

# LEAGUE NIGHT WITH A TENTACLED BOWLER

SKILL 46 · OUT AND ABOUT · AN EVENING · EASY

*Wednesday is league night, and the team is one short. Many visitors are wonderful bowlers, especially the ones with suction cups.*

1



*Rent the Shoes*
Visitors may need several pairs.

2



*Pick a Ball*
Find one with enough holes.

3



*Show the Approach*
Four steps and a smooth release.

MATERIALS


Bowling shoes


Your own ball


A score sheet


A bag of popcorn


A team shirt

4



*Keep Score*
A strike is an X. Visitors love drawing them.

5



*Cheer the Strike*
Jump up and clap.

## NOTES

Stand well back when a visitor bowls. Some of them throw from the ceiling.

**IMPORTANT**

Never lend a visitor your lucky ball.



6 *Celebrate With Popcorn*
Win or lose, popcorn.

HOW TO

# BUYING A HAT FOR A HEAD SHAPED LIKE THAT

SKILL 47 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

## MATERIALS

- A tape measure



- Your charge card



- A hatbox



- Hatpins



- Patience



*Every visitor wants a proper Earth hat, and the department store milliner is happy to help. It is simply a matter of finding one that fits around the antennae.*

1



*Visit the Hat Counter*
Third floor, past the gloves.

2



*Measure the Head*
Measure all the heads, if there is more than one.

3

*Try a Pillbox*
Small and tidy. Usually too small.



4



*Try a Wide Brim*
Plenty of room for antennae.

5



*Add a Feather*
Every hat is better with a feather.

6



*Pay and Box It*
Charge it, wrap it and carry it proudly.

## NOTES

Cut holes for the antennae at home with nail scissors. Department stores frown on it.

**IMPORTANT**

Never tell a visitor a hat makes their head look big.

CHAPTER EIGHT

8

# UNUSUAL SITUATIONS

*Tractor beams, shrink rays and other household emergencies*







Even the best-run household has the occasional emergency. In ordinary times that means a burnt roast or a flood in the basement. During an invasion it means being beamed aboard a mothership, shrunk to the size of a thimble, or finding a forty-foot visitor sitting on the house. Keep your apron on and read on.

IN THIS CHAPTER


48 Being Beamed Up With Your Hair Still Set
49 Escaping a Tractor Beam With the Vacuum Cleaner
50 Living Through a Shrink Ray
51 When a Forty-Foot Visitor Sits on the House
52 Talking Down the Galactic Overlord
53 Fixing a Saucer That Crashed in the Garden
54 Visiting the Mothership

HOW TO

# BEING BEAMED UP WITH YOUR HAIR STILL SET

SKILL 48 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · 5 MINUTES · HARD

*It happens quickly: a hum, a glow, and your feet leave the kitchen floor. Stay calm, hold your skirt and keep your hair in place. You will want to look nice when you arrive.*

## MATERIALS


Hairspray (lots)


A headscarf


Sensible shoes


Your handbag


A compact mirror

1



*Notice the Glow*

If the light through the window is green and humming, act fast.

2



*Spray Your Hair*

Two coats. It is windy up there.

3



*Tie a Headscarf*

Under the chin, double knot.

4



*Hold Your Skirt*

Float with dignity.

5



*Clutch Your Handbag*

Never leave the house without it, even through the ceiling.



6 *Check Your Compact*

Powder your nose before the hatch opens.

## NOTES

If there is time, leave a note for your husband: 'Casserole in the oven. Back soon.'

**IMPORTANT**

Never get beamed up in your slippers. You will regret it.

HOW TO

# ESCAPING A TRACTOR BEAM WITH THE VACUUM CLEANER

SKILL 49 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · 10 MINUTES · HARD

*Housewives know the vacuum cleaner is the most powerful machine in the house. Turned the right way, it can pull you right back out of a tractor beam.*

1



*Grab the Vacuum*

It is always nearby. Housewives keep it close.

2



*Plug It In*

Use the long cord. You may float a ways.

3

*Point It Down*

Hose aimed at the floor.



4



*Turn It On High*

The suction will pull you right back to the rug.

5



*Hold the Doorframe*

Once you're down, hang on.

6



*Vacuum Up the Beam*

While you're at it, suck up the last of it. It leaves dust.

## NOTES

This also works on the children when they won't come down from the tree house.

**IMPORTANT**

Empty the bag outdoors. Beam dust floats.

## MATERIALS

- An upright vacuum cleaner



- A long extension cord



- A sturdy doorframe



- A neighbor's phone number



- Courage



HOW TO

# LIVING THROUGH A SHRINK RAY

SKILL 50 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · ONE DAY · HARD

*One zap and suddenly the kitchen table is a mountain and the cat is a tiger. Don't despair. It wears off in a day, and in the meantime there is plenty you can do.*

## MATERIALS


A thimble (for a stool)


A matchbox (for a bed)


A handkerchief


A crumb of cake


A loud whistle

1



*Find Your Feet*

Everything is enormous. Take a deep breath.

2



*Avoid the Cat*

Hide behind the sugar bowl.

3



*Climb Down Carefully*

Use the tablecloth like a rope.

4



*Make a Bed*

A matchbox with a handkerchief is very snug.

5



*Eat a Crumb*

One cake crumb is a whole meal now.



6 *Wait for It to Wear Off*

Read a postage stamp. Count the floor tiles.

## NOTES

While you're small, look under the refrigerator. You'll find three earrings and the missing spoon.

**IMPORTANT**

Stay out of the path of the vacuum cleaner!

HOW TO

# WHEN A FORTY-FOOT VISITOR SITS ON THE HOUSE

SKILL 51 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · AN AFTERNOON · HARD

*Some visitors are very large and very tired. If one decides your house is a good place to sit, here is how to persuade it to move without hurting its feelings or your roof.*

1



*Step Out Front*
Look up. Way up.

2



*Use the Bullhorn*
Speak sweetly. 'Excuse me, dear!'

3

*Offer a Pie*
Wave it under its nose. Pies move mountains.



4



*Point to the Park*
A big open field is much more comfortable.

5



*Spray the Hose*
A light misting, if it won't budge.

6



*Check the Gutters*
Then telephone a roofer.

## NOTES

Giants are often shy. Don't point and laugh, even if the neighbors are.

**IMPORTANT**

Never let the children climb on it.

## MATERIALS

- A bullhorn



- A giant pie



- A ladder



- A bedsheet (for a napkin)



- A garden hose



HOW TO

# TALKING DOWN THE GALACTIC OVERLORD

SKILL 52 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · 1 HOUR · HARD

*Sooner or later you will meet the one in charge. He will be bigger, louder and wearing a cape. Don't be intimidated. You have handled the PTA president.*

## MATERIALS


Your best dress


A pot roast


A firm handshake


A list of demands (yours)


A cup of tea

1



*Dress Your Best*

Pearls. Always pearls.

2



*Bring a Pot Roast*

Nobody plans an invasion over pot roast.

3



*Meet His Gaze*

All of it.

4



*Pour the Tea*

Ask if he takes sugar.

5



*State Your Terms*

No more landing on lawns. Visits on weekends only. Wipe your feet.



6 *Ask for Your Dish Back*

A deal is a deal, and that was your good roasting pan.

## NOTES

Leaders are lonely. A little sympathy goes a long way.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't sit on the throne, even if he offers.

HOW TO

# FIXING A SAUCER THAT CRASHED IN THE GARDEN

SKILL 53 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · 2 HOURS · MEDIUM

*Not all visitors are good drivers. If one crashes into the vegetable patch, you can send it on its way with a few things from the kitchen drawer.*

1



*Check for Injuries*

Knock on the dome and ask if everyone is all right.

2



*Pull Off the Vines*

Many saucers get tangled in the beans.

3

*Patch the Dent*

Bubble gum works wonders on space metal.



4



*Fix the Wiring*

A bobby pin fits any panel.

5



*Give It a Push*

Like a stalled Buick.

6



*Wave as It Wobbles Off*

It may come back for the tomatoes.

## NOTES

Keep a spare bobby pin in your apron. Every machine in the galaxy takes one.

**IMPORTANT**

Fix the engine, not the ray gun.

## MATERIALS

- A toolbox



- Bubble gum



- Twine



- A bobby pin



- A tomato (to replace the squashed one)



HOW TO

# VISITING THE MOTHERSHIP

SKILL 54 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · AN EVENING · HARD

*If you are invited aboard, go. It is the social event of the century. Bring a hostess gift, wear comfortable shoes and remember everything for the bridge club.*

## MATERIALS


A hostess gift (a pie)


White gloves


Comfortable shoes


A camera


A notebook

1



*Reply Promptly*
Write a note and leave it on the lawn.

2



*Pick Your Gift*
A pie. Always a pie.

3



*Ride Up the Beam*
Hold on to your hat.

4



*Take the Tour*
Admire everything, especially the kitchen.

5



*Take a Snapshot*
Nobody at the bridge club will believe you.



6 *Thank Your Hosts*
A handwritten note the very next day.

## NOTES

Ask for the recipe of anything you eat. Their pudding is said to be divine.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't push any buttons. One of them is Ohio.

CHAPTER NINE

9

# PEACE BETWEEN THE PLANETS

*Making friends across the galaxy, one casserole at a time*







In the end, every invasion turns into a neighborhood. The visitors stay, the saucers get parked in garages, and the Hendersons' new friend from Neptune joins the bowling league. This last chapter is about the best part: making friends. Because whatever planet you come from, everybody likes a good meal, a warm welcome and a neighbor who waves.

IN THIS CHAPTER


55 Throwing a Welcome-to-the-Neighborhood Potluck
56 Teaching an Alien to Dance at the Sock Hop
57 Swapping Recipes Across the Galaxy
58 Hosting a Plastic Container Party for the Visitors
59 Writing to a Pen Pal on Mars
60 Waving Goodbye at the Launch Pad

HOW TO

# THROWING A WELCOME-TO-THE-NEIGHBORHOOD POTLUCK

SKILL 55 · PEACE BETWEEN THE PLANETS · A DAY · MEDIUM

*The fastest way to end an invasion is to invite everybody to supper. Long tables, lots of casseroles and a sign that says 'All Welcome'.*

## MATERIALS

- Long folding tables



- Invitations for every house and saucer



- A big casserole



- Paper lanterns



- Lemonade



1



*Send Invitations*
To every house and every saucer.

2



*Set Up the Tables*
End to end, right down the street.

*Hang the Lanterns*
Paper lanterns look lovely at dusk.

3



4



*Lay Out the Food*
Casseroles, gelatin, deviled eggs and three kinds of pie.

5



*Welcome Every Guest*
Hand out plates and paper napkins.

6



*Toast the New Neighbors*
Raise your lemonade.

## NOTES

Label the dishes. Visitors are very curious about what goes into a casserole.

**IMPORTANT**

Put the gelatin far from the blobs, in case of family reunions.

HOW TO

# TEACHING AN ALIEN TO DANCE AT THE SOCK HOP

SKILL 56 · PEACE BETWEEN THE PLANETS · AN EVENING · EASY

*Rock and roll is a universal language, and every visitor is eager to learn the twist. Some have more feet than others, which helps.*

1



*Clear the Floor*
Roll up the rug.

2



*Put On a Record*
Something with a good beat.

3



*Show the Basic Step*
Step, step, rock back.

## MATERIALS


A record player


Rock and roll records


Bobby socks


A polished floor


Punch

4



*Count the Feet*
Each one needs to know where to go.

5



*Try the Twist*
Visitors are naturals.



6 *Serve the Punch*
Dancing is thirsty work.

## NOTES

Teach them the hand jive. They have plenty of hands.

**IMPORTANT**

Mind the slow dance. Some visitors squeeze.

HOW TO

# SWAPPING RECIPES ACROSS THE GALAXY

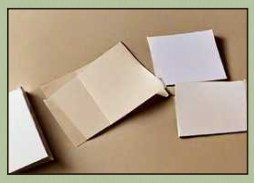
SKILL 57 · PEACE BETWEEN THE PLANETS · 1 HOUR · EASY

## MATERIALS

- A recipe box



- Blank index cards



- A pen



- A measuring cup



- An open mind



*Visitors have recipes too, and some of them are delicious. Trading recipe cards is the friendliest kind of diplomacy there is.*

1



*Bring Out Your Recipe Box*

Your best: meatloaf, pie and the famous casserole.

2



*Write Out a Card*

Neat handwriting. They are still learning to read.

3

*Receive Theirs*

It may glow. That is normal.



4



*Try It Together*

Follow every step, even the strange ones.

5



*Taste Bravely*

A small spoonful. Nod thoughtfully.

6



*File It Away*

Under S, for Space.

## NOTES

Nebula pudding goes beautifully with vanilla ice cream.

**IMPORTANT**

If a recipe calls for 'one moon', use a grapefruit.

HOW TO

# HOSTING A PLASTIC CONTAINER PARTY FOR THE VISITORS

SKILL 58 · PEACE BETWEEN THE PLANETS · AN AFTERNOON · EASY

*Nothing brings neighbors together like plastic containers with lids that burp. Visitors, who have never seen a lid that seals, are astonished.*

1



*Lay Out the Samples*

Arrange the colors in a rainbow. Visitors love rainbows.

2



*Demonstrate the Burp*

Press the lid and lift one corner. Pffft.

3



*Let Them Try*

They will want to do it a hundred times.

MATERIALS



A catalog



Sample containers



Order forms



Coffee cake



A door prize

4



*Serve Coffee Cake*

Store the leftovers in a sample. Very clever.

5



*Take the Orders*

Visitors buy in bulk. Very big bulk.

## NOTES

They use the containers to carry leftovers back to their home planet. Very thrifty.

**IMPORTANT**

Never let a blob demonstrate the seal from the inside.



6 *Award the Door Prize*

A big bowl with a lid.

HOW TO

# WRITING TO A PEN PAL ON MARS

SKILL 59 · PEACE BETWEEN THE PLANETS · 30 MINUTES · EASY

*When the visitors go home, keep in touch. A letter a month keeps a friendship warm across thirty-five million miles.*

## MATERIALS

- Nice writing paper



- A fountain pen



- Envelopes



- Lots of stamps



- A photograph of the family



1



*Start With the Weather*
'It is sunny here. Is it dusty there?'

2



*Share the News*
Report the bake sale results in full.

3

*Enclose a Photograph*
So they remember your face.



4



*Stamp It Heavily*
Mars is a long way. Use the whole sheet.

5



*Mail It*
The mailman will give you a funny look. Smile.

6



*Read the Reply*
It may arrive by meteor. Check the yard.

## NOTES

Ask them to send a recipe in every letter.

**IMPORTANT**

Don't open envelopes that are ticking.

HOW TO

# WAVING GOODBYE AT THE LAUNCH PAD

SKILL 60 · PEACE BETWEEN THE PLANETS · AN AFTERNOON · EASY

*All good visits come to an end. When it's time for your new friends to go home, give them a proper Earth send-off: pie, hugs and a great deal of waving.*

1



*Bake One More Pie*
For the road.

2



*Pack the Leftovers*
In plastic containers, naturally.

3



*Walk to the Saucer*
Slowly. Make it last.

MATERIALS


A pie for the road


A handkerchief


A thermos of coffee


The whole family


A promise to write

4



*Hand Over the Pie*
Say 'Come back soon.'

5



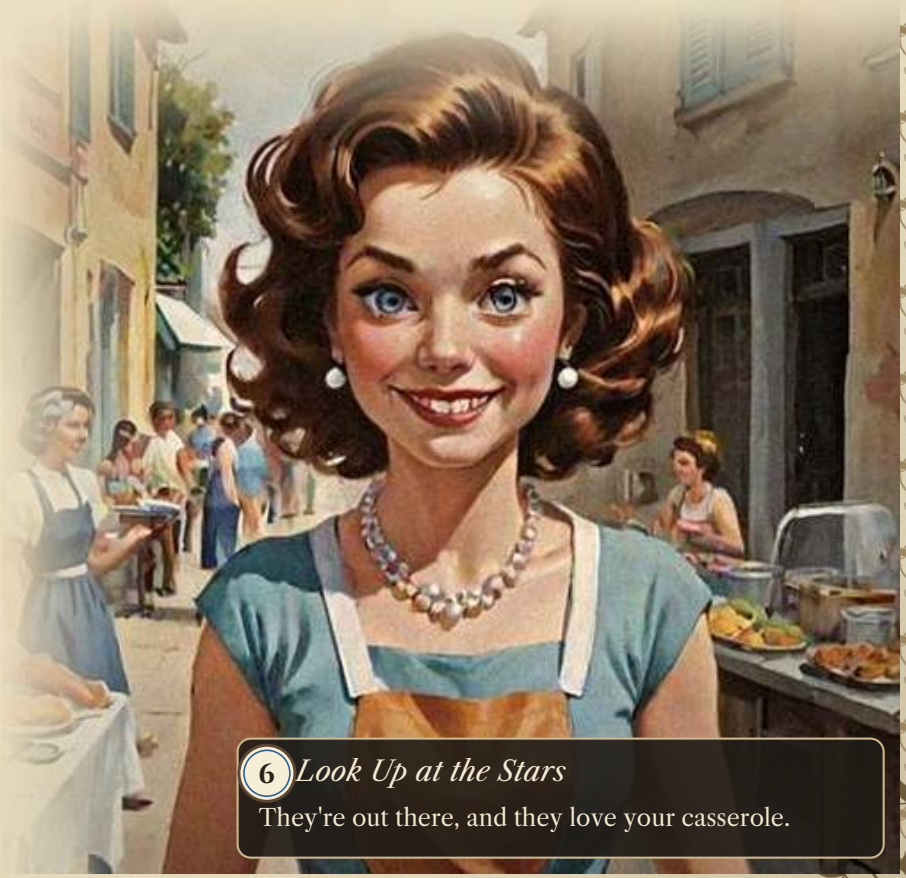
*Wave Your Handkerchief*
Until it's just a dot.

## NOTES

Leave the porch light on. You never know who might drop by.

**IMPORTANT**

Never promise to visit them. It's a very long trip, and nobody up there has heard of a rest stop.



6 *Look Up at the Stars*
They're out there, and they love your casserole.

# APPENDIX

*Charts, checklists and quick references*

## A. FIELD GUIDE TO VISITORS

Who you are likely to meet, where they come from and the friendliest response. Sightings increase sharply on warm Tuesday evenings.

| VISITOR | FROM | LOOKS LIKE | FAVORITE FOOD | WHAT TO DO |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Glorpian | Planet Glorp | Green, eyes on stalks | Tuna casserole | Offer a plate |
| Purple Blob | The Blob Nebula | One huge eyeball | Green gelatin | Hide the gelatin |
| Brainiac | Mercury | Brain in a glass dome | Meatloaf | Lose at bridge |
| Fuzzle | The Fuzz Belt | Orange shag, six eyes | Cookies | Brush it outdoors |
| Octopod | Neptune | Teal, many tentacles | Fruit cocktail | Lay a rubber mat |
| Peeper | Pluto | Pink, covered in eyes | Mashed potatoes | Make eye contact |
| Snorkeler | Saturn's rings | Striped, trunk nose | Frying pans | Hide the toaster |
| Space pet | Varies | Six legs, glows | Your lawn | Use a leash |
| Galactic Overlord | The mothership | Cape, many eyes | Pot roast | Pour him tea |

## B. FEEDING CHART

What to serve each visitor, meal by meal. Portions are for one guest; double them for anything with more than one mouth.

| GUEST | BREAKFAST | LUNCH | SUPPER | NEVER SERVE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Glorpian | Pancakes | Tuna salad | Casserole | Escargot |
| Purple Blob | Oatmeal | Jell-O salad | More Jell-O | Its cousin |
| Brainiac | Toast | Egg salad | Meatloaf | Brain food |
| Fuzzle | Muffins | Cookies | Cookies | Anything sticky |
| Octopod | Fruit cocktail | Clam chowder | Fish sticks | Calamari |
| Snorkeler | Bottle caps | A hubcap | Old pots | Your good silver |
| Small visitors | One crumb | Half a pea | A drop of gravy | Anything bigger |

# C. CHECKLISTS

Copy these pages and tick items off as you get ready. Check the foil supply and the hairspray every week.



### INVASION EMERGENCY KIT

- ☐ Six rolls of aluminum foil
- ☐ A full invasion pantry (see Chapter 2)
- ☐ A hand can opener
- ☐ Hairspray (extra hold)
- ☐ A headscarf
- ☐ A quilted pot holder
- ☐ An upright vacuum cleaner and a long cord
- ☐ A whistle
- ☐ Rubber gloves and vinegar
- ☐ A wooden table radio
- ☐ A spare bobby pin
- ☐ A good sense of humor

### BEFORE THE VISITORS COME TO SUPPER

- ☐ Count the arms (and the forks)
- ☐ Lay the rubber mat
- ☐ Make a gelatin mold
- ☐ Bake a tuna casserole
- ☐ Hide the toaster
- ☐ Put mints by the door
- ☐ Choose three safe topics
- ☐ Fill the plant mister
- ☐ Wrap a plate of leftovers

### MOTHERSHIP OVERNIGHT BAG

- ☐ A pie (hostess gift)
- ☐ White gloves
- ☐ Comfortable shoes
- ☐ A compact mirror
- ☐ A box camera
- ☐ A notebook for the bridge club
- ☐ A note for your husband
- ☐ A toothbrush
- ☐ A sweater (it's cold up there)
- ☐ Your handbag

## D. HOUSEHOLD REMEDIES FOR SPACE STAINS

Every visitor leaves something behind. Test each remedy on a hidden corner first, and always wear rubber gloves around anything that glows.

| STAIN OR SPILL | REMEDY | NOTES |
|---|---|---|
| Green slime | Vinegar and water | Blot, never rub |
| Purple slime | Club soda | Works on grape juice too |
| Glowing puddles | Baking soda paste | Clean with the lights off |
| Scorch marks | Fresh white bread | Rub gently on wallpaper |
| Frost from a freeze ray | Hair dryer on medium | Lay towels first |
| Moon dust | Damp cloth | Never the vacuum |
| Orange fur | Lint brush | Brush the guest outdoors |
| Tentacle prints | Floor wax | Buff in circles |
| Beam dust | Open the windows | It floats away |
| Gelatin on the ceiling | A long-handled mop | Ask the guest to stop bouncing |
| Ray-gun burn on a tablecloth | Lemon juice and sun | Or a nice centerpiece |
| Mystery goo | Rubber gloves | Do not taste |

## E. HANDY INVASION CONVERSIONS

| MEASURE | ROUGHLY EQUALS |
|---|---|
| 1 flying saucer | The size of the Hendersons' lawn |
| 1 mothership | About 300 saucers, or Cleveland |
| 1 tentacle | 3 forks at dinner |
| 1 tuna casserole | Feeds 40 mouths, or 1 Glorpian |
| 1 green gelatin mold | Ends 1 invasion, usually |
| 1 tractor beam | About 2 minutes of floating |
| 1 shrink ray | Makes you the size of a thimble for a day |
| 1 light-year | A very long drive with the children |
| 1 Martian year | About 2 Earth years of visiting |
| 1 roll of aluminum foil | Covers 1 window, ruffle included |
| 1 warm welcome | Priceless |

# F. HOUSEHOLD INVASION CARD

Fill this in together and pin a copy by the telephone and inside the pantry door.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Household name** | |
| **Date the first saucer was spotted** | |
| **Saucers on our street (count)** | |
| **Our safe room is the** | |
| **Our emergency casserole** | |
| **Tinfoil is kept in** | |
| **Hairspray is kept in** | |
| **Our visitor's name** | |
| **Number of its eyes** | |
| **Its favorite food** | |
| **Next potluck date** | |
| **Days until they go home** | |

### IMPORTANT NUMBERS

| | |
|---|---|
| Emergency | 911 |
| The radio station | |
| My husband's office | |
| The bridge club | |
| The beauty parlor | |
| The church hall | |
| Neighbor (human) | |
| Neighbor (visitor) | |

## G. GLOSSARY

**Abduction.** Being invited aboard a saucer without being asked first. Very rude.

**Antennae.** The feelers on top of many visitors' heads. Never use them as a hat rack.

**Beam.** A glowing column of light from a saucer. Floats people, cars and casseroles.

**Crop circle.** A pattern pressed into a garden by a landing saucer. A visitor's calling card.

**Flying saucer.** A round, shiny craft from another world. Often parked on the wrong lawn.

**Freeze ray.** A gadget that frosts whatever it points at. Thaw with a hair dryer.

**Gelatin mold.** A wobbly dessert that visitors adore. Some think it is family.

**Glorpian.** A green visitor with three eyes on stalks. Loves tuna casserole.

**Hatch.** The door of a saucer. Knock before polishing.

**Light-year.** The distance light travels in a year. Too far to borrow a cup of sugar.

**Martian.** A visitor from Mars. Also, loosely, any visitor at all.

**Mothership.** The very large saucer where the important visitors live.

**Overlord.** The visitor in charge. Wears a cape. Weak spot: pot roast.

**Ray gun.** A visitor's tool, mostly used by accident. Keep it in the saucer.

**Shrink ray.** A ray that makes you very small for about a day.

**Slime.** What some visitors leave behind. Blot, never rub.

**Tentacle.** A long, bendy arm. Count them before setting the table.

**Tinfoil.** Aluminum foil. Confuses alien instruments and brightens any room.

## H. WHERE TO LEARN MORE

- **The night sky:** your public library has friendly books on the stars and planets. Learn where the visitors come from.
- **Home economics:** the cookbook shelf at the library. Every new recipe is a new friend.
- **Meeting your neighbors:** church suppers, block parties and the PTA. Go to all of them, and bring a casserole.
- **Staying calm:** a cup of tea, a comfortable chair and fifteen minutes with the radio off.
- **Stargazing:** a blanket on the lawn on a clear night. Wave if anything waves back.

# INDEX


A

abduction . . . . . 36, 68
Anchoring the Station Wagon Against Tractor Beams 26
Answering the Door to an Alien . . . . . 30

B

babies . . . . . 54
babysitting . . . . . 54
Babysitting a Baby From Beyond . . . . . 54
baking . . . . . 42
Baking a Welcome-to-Earth Cake . . . . . 42
barking . . . . . 56
basement . . . . . 23
beauty parlor . . . . . 61
bedtime . . . . . 57
beige . . . . . 28
Being Beamed Up With Your Hair Still Set . . . . . 68
board games . . . . . 23
books . . . . . 62
bowling . . . . . 65
bridge . . . . . 33
Bringing a Visitor to the PTA Meeting . . . . . 63
bulletins . . . . . 17
Buying a Hat for a Head Shaped Like That . . . . . 66

C

cake . . . . . 42
calm . . . . . 19
Calming a Dog Who Barks at Saucers . . . . . 56
can opener . . . . . 22
canned goods . . . . . 22
cards . . . . . 33
carpet . . . . . 45
casserole . . . . . 38
cats . . . . . 70
celebrations . . . . . 42
checklists . . . . . 83
children . . . . . 19, 53, 57
china . . . . . 25
chores . . . . . 50
chrome . . . . . 48
church . . . . . 64
Church Picnic With Unexpected Guests . . . . . 64
coffee . . . . . 35
conversation . . . . . 32
cookies . . . . . 19
cooking . . . . . 78
costumes . . . . . 58
crash . . . . . 73
crop circles . . . . . 16
curlers . . . . . 61
curtains . . . . . 21

D

dancing . . . . . 77
defrosting . . . . . 49
Defrosting the Kitchen After a Freeze Ray . . . . . 49
department store . . . . . 66
desserts . . . . . 39
dinner . . . . . 40
diplomacy . . . . . 40
disguise . . . . . 28
disguises . . . . . 15, 18
dogs . . . . . 56
doorbell . . . . . 30

E

emergency kit . . . . . 83
errands . . . . . 60, 62
escape . . . . . 69
Escaping a Tractor Beam With the Vacuum Cleaner 69
Explaining Aliens at Bedtime . . . . . 57

F

Feeding a Visitor Who Eats Metal . . . . . 43
feeding chart . . . . . 82
field guide . . . . . 82

Finding a Crop Circle in the Petunias . . . . . 16
Fixing a Saucer That Crashed in the Garden . . . . . 73
flamingos . . . . . 28
flying saucers . . . . . 14
footprints . . . . . 15
forks . . . . . 31
freeze ray . . . . . 49
friendship . . . . . 78, 81
furniture . . . . . 34

G

garden . . . . . 16, 24, 73
gelatin . . . . . 39
Getting Alien Slime Out of the Carpet . . . . . 45
Getting Ray-Gun Scorch Marks Off the Wallpaper . 51
Getting Your Hair Set Next to a Martian . . . . . 61
giants . . . . . 71
goodbyes . . . . . 36, 81
greetings . . . . . 30
grocery shopping . . . . . 60
Grocery Shopping During an Invasion . . . . . 60

H

hair . . . . . 61
hair dryer . . . . . 49
hairspray . . . . . 68
Halloween . . . . . 58
Hanging Tinfoil Curtains . . . . . 21
hats . . . . . 66
helpers . . . . . 50
hostess . . . . . 30
hostess gifts . . . . . 74
Hosting a Bridge Party With Visitors . . . . . 33
Hosting a Plastic Container Party for the Visitors . . 79
husband . . . . . 18

I

invasion card . . . . . 85
invitations . . . . . 74
ironing . . . . . 46
Is That Really Your Husband? . . . . . 18

K

keeping aliens . . . . . 53
Keeping the Household Calm . . . . . 19
Keeping the Lawn Saucer-Free . . . . . 27

L

landing . . . . . 27
large guests . . . . . 34
Laundering a Space Suit . . . . . 46
laundry . . . . . 46, 50
lawn . . . . . 27
league night . . . . . 65
League Night With a Tentacled Bowler . . . . . 65
leash . . . . . 55
leftovers . . . . . 36, 79
letters . . . . . 80
library . . . . . 62
Living Through a Shrink Ray . . . . . 70
lullabies . . . . . 54
lunch . . . . . 41

M

Making Small Talk With a Martian . . . . . 32
Making the Basement Shelter Cozy . . . . . 23
Making Your House Look Boring From Above . . . 28
manners . . . . . 35
marigolds . . . . . 24
Mars . . . . . 80
Martians . . . . . 32
meatloaf . . . . . 18, 40
Meatloaf Diplomacy . . . . . 40
meetings . . . . . 63
metal . . . . . 43
milkman . . . . . 15
molds . . . . . 39
mothership . . . . . 74

N

negotiation . . . . . 72

neighbors . . . . . 76
news . . . . . 17

O

overlord . . . . . 72

P

Packing a Lunch for a Long Space Voyage . . . . . 41
pantry . . . . . 22
parties . . . . . 33, 76, 79
Peacekeeping Green Gelatin Mold . . . . . 39
pen pals . . . . . 80
pets . . . . . 53, 55, 56
petunias . . . . . 16
picnic . . . . . 64
pie . . . . . 81
pie tins . . . . . 14
pies . . . . . 71
Planting an Alien-Repelling Marigold Border . . . . 24
plastic containers . . . . . 79
polishing . . . . . 48
Polishing a Flying Saucer . . . . . 48
pot holders . . . . . 25
pot roast . . . . . 72
potluck . . . . . 64, 76
PTA . . . . . 63
Putting a Many-Armed Visitor to Work . . . . . 50

R

radio . . . . . 17
ray guns . . . . . 25, 51
Ray-Proofing the Good China . . . . . 25
rays . . . . . 21
recipes . . . . . 38, 78, 82
remedies . . . . . 84
repairs . . . . . 73
repelling . . . . . 24
rock and roll . . . . . 77
roof . . . . . 71
rope . . . . . 26

S

sandwiches . . . . . 41
saucer . . . . . 48
Saying Goodbye Without Being Abducted . . . . . 36
school . . . . . 63
scorch marks . . . . . 51
seating . . . . . 34
Seating a Guest Who Won't Fit on the Sofa . . . . . 34
serving . . . . . 35
Serving Coffee to Something With No Mouth . . . . 35
Setting the Table for a Guest With Seven Arms . . . 31
sewing . . . . . 58
Sewing a Halloween Costume Nobody Will Question 58
shelter . . . . . 23
shopping . . . . . 66
shrink ray . . . . . 70
sightings . . . . . 14
slime . . . . . 45
small . . . . . 70
small aliens . . . . . 47
small talk . . . . . 32
sock hop . . . . . 77
space suits . . . . . 46
sports . . . . . 65
Spotting a Flying Saucer . . . . . 14
sprinklers . . . . . 27
stains . . . . . 45, 84
station wagon . . . . . 26
Stocking the Invasion Pantry . . . . . 22
stories . . . . . 57
supermarket . . . . . 60
Swapping Recipes Across the Galaxy . . . . . 78

T

table setting . . . . . 31
Taking a Visitor to the Public Library . . . . . 62
Talking Down the Galactic Overlord . . . . . 72
Teaching an Alien to Dance at the Sock Hop . . . . 77
Telling an Alien From the Milkman . . . . . 15
tentacles . . . . . 31

Throwing a Welcome-to-the-Neighborhood Potluck 76
tinfoil . . . . . 21
toaster . . . . . 43
tractor beams . . . . . 26, 68, 69
travel . . . . . 41
tuna . . . . . 38
Tuna Casserole for Forty Mouths . . . . . 38

U

Understanding the Radio Bulletin . . . . . 17
unusual diets . . . . . 43

V

vacuum cleaner . . . . . 47, 69
vacuuming . . . . . 47
Vacuuming Up a Very Small Alien (and Letting It Out) 47
Visiting the Mothership . . . . . 74
visitors . . . . . 82

W

walking . . . . . 55
Walking a Space Pet . . . . . 55
wallpaper . . . . . 51
Waving Goodbye at the Launch Pad . . . . . 81
When a Forty-Foot Visitor Sits on the House . . . . 71
When Junior Brings One Home . . . . . 53
Writing to a Pen Pal on Mars . . . . . 80

# MY SKILLS LOG

*Tick off each skill once your household has done it. Visitors may not tick their own boxes.*

| # | SKILL | DATE TRIED | DONE |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Spotting a Flying Saucer | | ☐ |
| 02 | Telling an Alien From the Milkman | | ☐ |
| 03 | Finding a Crop Circle in the Petunias | | ☐ |
| 04 | Understanding the Radio Bulletin | | ☐ |
| 05 | Is That Really Your Husband? | | ☐ |
| 06 | Keeping the Household Calm | | ☐ |
| 07 | Hanging Tinfoil Curtains | | ☐ |
| 08 | Stocking the Invasion Pantry | | ☐ |
| 09 | Making the Basement Shelter Cozy | | ☐ |
| 10 | Planting an Alien-Repelling Marigold Border | | ☐ |
| 11 | Ray-Proofing the Good China | | ☐ |
| 12 | Anchoring the Station Wagon Against Tractor Beams | | ☐ |
| 13 | Keeping the Lawn Saucer-Free | | ☐ |
| 14 | Making Your House Look Boring From Above | | ☐ |
| 15 | Answering the Door to an Alien | | ☐ |
| 16 | Setting the Table for a Guest With Seven Arms | | ☐ |
| 17 | Making Small Talk With a Martian | | ☐ |
| 18 | Hosting a Bridge Party With Visitors | | ☐ |
| 19 | Seating a Guest Who Won't Fit on the Sofa | | ☐ |
| 20 | Serving Coffee to Something With No Mouth | | ☐ |
| 21 | Saying Goodbye Without Being Abducted | | ☐ |
| 22 | Tuna Casserole for Forty Mouths | | ☐ |
| 23 | The Peacekeeping Green Gelatin Mold | | ☐ |
| 24 | Meatloaf Diplomacy | | ☐ |
| 25 | Packing a Lunch for a Long Space Voyage | | ☐ |
| 26 | Baking a Welcome-to-Earth Cake | | ☐ |
| 27 | Feeding a Visitor Who Eats Metal | | ☐ |
| 28 | Getting Alien Slime Out of the Carpet | | ☐ |
| 29 | Laundering a Space Suit | | ☐ |
| 30 | Vacuuming Up a Very Small Alien (and Letting It Out) | | ☐ |
| 31 | Polishing a Flying Saucer | | ☐ |
| 32 | Defrosting the Kitchen After a Freeze Ray | | ☐ |
| 33 | Putting a Many-Armed Visitor to Work | | ☐ |
| 34 | Getting Ray-Gun Scorch Marks Off the Wallpaper | | ☐ |
| 35 | When Junior Brings One Home | | ☐ |
| 36 | Babysitting a Baby From Beyond | | ☐ |
| 37 | Walking a Space Pet | | ☐ |
| 38 | Calming a Dog Who Barks at Saucers | | ☐ |

| # | SKILL | DATE TRIED | DONE |
|---|---|---|---|
| 39 | Explaining Aliens at Bedtime | | ☐ |
| 40 | Sewing a Halloween Costume Nobody Will Question | | ☐ |
| 41 | Grocery Shopping During an Invasion | | ☐ |
| 42 | Getting Your Hair Set Next to a Martian | | ☐ |
| 43 | Taking a Visitor to the Public Library | | ☐ |
| 44 | Bringing a Visitor to the PTA Meeting | | ☐ |
| 45 | A Church Picnic With Unexpected Guests | | ☐ |
| 46 | League Night With a Tentacled Bowler | | ☐ |
| 47 | Buying a Hat for a Head Shaped Like That | | ☐ |
| 48 | Being Beamed Up With Your Hair Still Set | | ☐ |
| 49 | Escaping a Tractor Beam With the Vacuum Cleaner | | ☐ |
| 50 | Living Through a Shrink Ray | | ☐ |
| 51 | When a Forty-Foot Visitor Sits on the House | | ☐ |
| 52 | Talking Down the Galactic Overlord | | ☐ |
| 53 | Fixing a Saucer That Crashed in the Garden | | ☐ |
| 54 | Visiting the Mothership | | ☐ |
| 55 | Throwing a Welcome-to-the-Neighborhood Potluck | | ☐ |
| 56 | Teaching an Alien to Dance at the Sock Hop | | ☐ |
| 57 | Swapping Recipes Across the Galaxy | | ☐ |
| 58 | Hosting a Plastic Container Party for the Visitors | | ☐ |
| 59 | Writing to a Pen Pal on Mars | | ☐ |
| 60 | Waving Goodbye at the Launch Pad | | ☐ |

# NOTES

*Saucers spotted, casseroles served, slime removed, and the names of every visitor you have fed.*

## THE BOOK EVERY AMERICAN HOMEMAKER NEEDS

It starts with a hum over the backyard. By lunchtime there is a crop circle in the petunias, a milkman with three eyes and something large and purple on the Hendersons' lawn. All across America the saucers are landing, and almost no one knows what to serve them.

*The Housewife's Guide to Alien Invasions* is here to help: sixty sensible skills, each laid out on a single page with a picture for every step, a materials panel and notes on what can go wrong. Tabs on every page help you find what you need, even while a tractor beam is lifting the station wagon.

INSIDE YOU WILL LEARN HOW TO

- Tell an alien from the milkman
- Hang tinfoil curtains
- Seat a guest with seven arms
- Make the peacekeeping gelatin mold
- Get slime out of the carpet
- Babysit a baby from beyond
- Get your hair set next to a Martian
- Escape a tractor beam with the vacuum
- Talk down the Galactic Overlord
- Throw a potluck for the whole galaxy



*"No invasion ever survived a second helping."*
OLD KITCHEN SAYING

# THE HOUSEWIFE'S GUIDE TO ALIEN INVASIONS

*Home / Outer Space / Humor*

FUN BOOKS · HOME EDITION